

The Joy of Pseudo-Boolean Proof Logging

Jakob Nordström

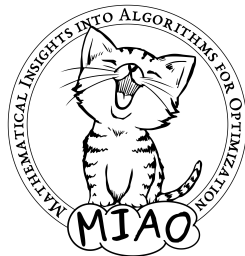
University of Copenhagen and Lund University

ACP Summer School 2026

CP: Explanation, Verification, and Applications

Changchun, China

August 24–28, 2026



The Joy of Pseudo-Boolean Proof Logging

Or: An Introduction to VERIPB

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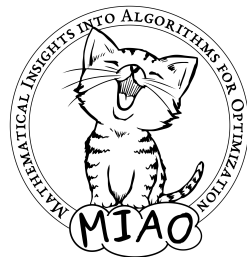
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Brief Presentation

Jakob Nordström

University of Copenhagen
and Lund University

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www.jakobnordstrom.se

Research interests:

- Computational complexity theory
- Applied combinatorial optimization
- Certifying algorithms / proof logging



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Research interests:

- *Proving exponential lower bounds for NP-hard problems*
- *Designing algorithms to solve NP-hard problems in (ideally) linear time*
- *Generating machine-verifiable proofs that such algorithms reason correctly*



Tutorial Based on Research Contributions By...

■ Berhan Oumer Adame

■ Markus Anders

■ Jeremias Berg

■ Bart Bogaerts

■ Benjamin Bogø

■ Wolf De Wulf

■ Emir Demirović

■ Simon Dold

■ Jan Elffers

■ Ambros Gleixner

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Combinatorial Solving and Optimisation

- Revolution last couple of decades in **combinatorial solvers** for
 - Boolean satisfiability (SAT) solving [BHvMW21]¹
 - Constraint programming (CP) [RvBW06]
 - Mixed integer linear programming (MIP) [AW13, BR07]
- Solve NP-complete problems (or worse) very successfully in practice!
- **Except solvers are sometimes wrong...** (Even best commercial ones) [BLB10, CKSW13, AGJ⁺18, GSD19, BMN22, GCS23]
- Solvers can propose infeasible “solutions” (but such errors can be detected)
- More challenging: How to achieve reliable claims of infeasibility?
- Or that a solution is optimal? (Even off-by-one mistakes can snowball into large errors if solver used as subroutine)

¹See end of slides for all references with bibliographic details

What Can Be Done About Solver Bugs?

■ Software testing

Very useful, but bugs slip through even with careful domain-specific testing

Progress using [fuzzing](#) and [delta debugging](#) [BB09, BLB10, KB22, NPB22, PB23]

But testing inherently can only detect presence of bugs, not absence

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■ Formal methods

Prove that solver implementation adheres to formal specification

Current [formal verification](#) techniques cannot scale to level of complexity in modern solvers
(Despite valiant efforts in, e.g., [Fle20])

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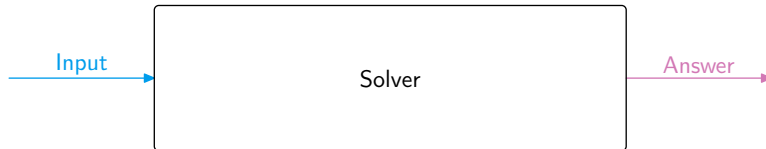
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■ Proof logging

Make solver [certifying](#) [ABM⁺11, MMNS11] by adding code so that it outputs

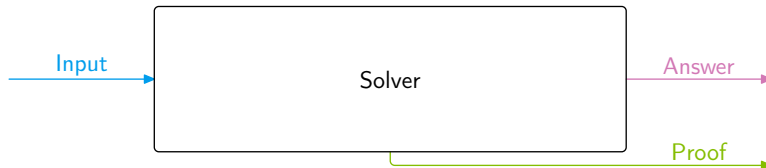
- 1 not only [answer](#) but also
- 2 simple, machine-verifiable [proof](#) that answer is correct

Proof Logging with Certifying Solvers: Workflow



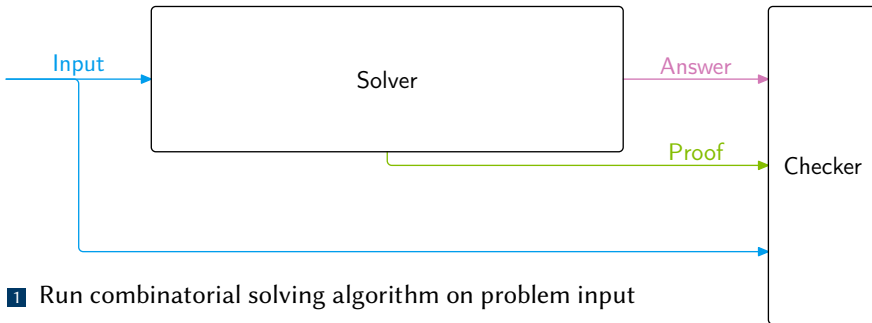
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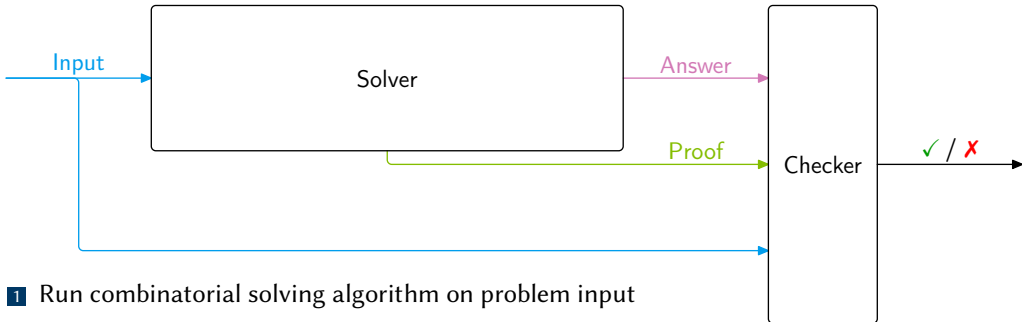
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Proof Logging with Certifying Solvers: Workflow



- 1 Run combinatorial solving algorithm on problem input
- 2 Get as output not only answer but also proof
- 3 Feed input + answer + proof to proof checker

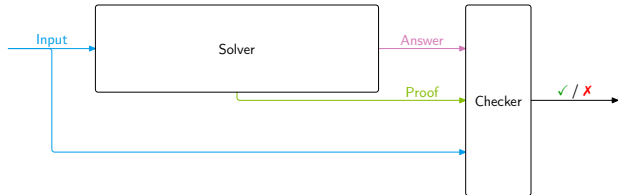
Proof Logging with Certifying Solvers: Workflow



- 1 Run combinatorial solving algorithm on problem input
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- 3 Feed input + answer + proof to proof checker
- 4 Verify that proof checker says answer is correct

Proof Logging Desiderata

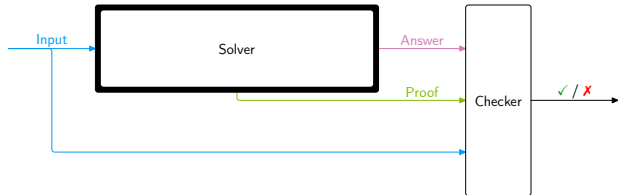
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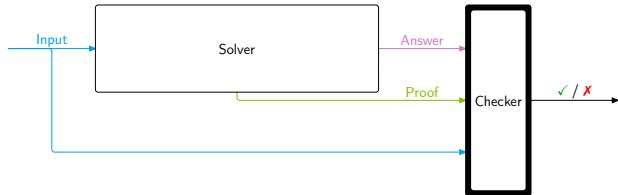
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Proof Logging Desiderata

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- **very powerful:** minimal overhead for sophisticated reasoning
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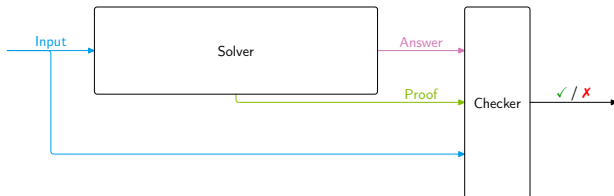


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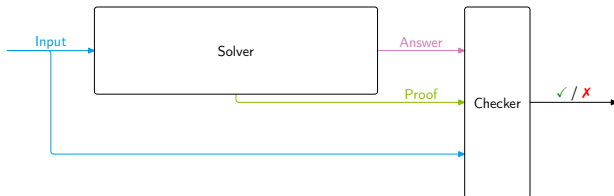
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Clear conflict expressivity vs. simplicity!



Proof Logging Desiderata



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Clear conflict expressivity vs. simplicity!

Asking for both perhaps a little bit too good to be true?

Some Previous Proof Logging Work

Boolean satisfiability (SAT) solving

- Well established since over decade with several proof formats such as [DRAT](#) [HHW13a, HHW13b, WHH14], [GRIT](#) [CMS17], [LRAT](#) [CHH⁺17], ...
- But no efficient support for most advanced techniques such as
 - Gaussian elimination
 - symmetry breaking
- And only for decision problems, not optimization (MaxSAT)

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Mixed integer linear programming

- Work on proof format [VIPR](#) [CGS17, EG23]
- But only for exact solving and without support for advanced techniques

Take-Away Message from This Tutorial

Proof logging for sophisticated combinatorial solvers is possible!



Take-Away Message from This Tutorial

Proof logging for sophisticated combinatorial solvers is possible!

- With **single, unified method!**
- Producing proofs in simple format calculating with **0–1 integer linear inequalities** (a.k.a. **pseudo-Boolean constraints**)
- Implemented in **VeriPB** (<https://VeriPB.org>)



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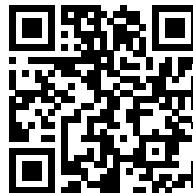
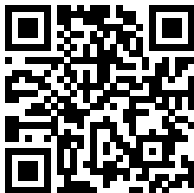
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These slides with references are online at <https://jakobnordstrom.se/presentations/>

Software for Exercises Tomorrow Thursday



Kindling: See [README.md](#) and files in [slides-proofs/](#)

<https://github.com/ciaranm/kindling>

VeriPB (official version): See [README.md](#) and try to run `veripb justified.opb justified.pbpb`

<https://gitlab.com/MIA0research/software/VeriPB>

VeriPB (experimental): Interactive mode (Linux and Mac only?); see [README.md](#) and then use `cargo run -p veripb-repl -m path-to-veripb-repl/Cargo.toml`

<https://github.com/ciaranm/veripb-repl>

The Sales Pitch For Proof Logging

- 1 Certifies correctness of computed results

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- 2 **Detects errors** even if due to compiler bugs, hardware failures, or cosmic rays

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- 6 Enables auditability
- 7 Serves as stepping stone towards explainability

Design Principles for Proof Logging

Proof logging implementation

- Don't change solver
- Just add proof logging print statements (plus some book-keeping) to solver code

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Performance goals

- Proof logging overhead small constant fraction of running time ($\lesssim 10\%$)
- Proof checking time within constant factor of solving time (current aim $\lesssim \times 10$)

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Proof system

- Keep language simple — no XOR constraints, CP propagators, symmetry groups, ...
- But reason efficiently about such notions using power of proof system
- Combine proof logging with formally verified proof checker

But Let Us Start from the Beginning...

Review of some basic concepts:

- SATISFIABILITY (SAT) problem
- Unit propagation
- DPLL and CDCL algorithms
- Resolution proof system

The SATISFIABILITY (SAT) Problem

- **Variable** x : takes value **true** (=1) or **false** (=0)
- **Literal** ℓ : variable x or its negation $\bar{x}$
- **Clause** $C = \ell_1 \vee \dots \vee \ell_k$: disjunction of literals
(Consider as sets, so no repetitions and order irrelevant)
- **Conjunctive normal form (CNF) formula** $F = C_1 \wedge \dots \wedge C_m$: conjunction of clauses

The SAT Problem

Given a CNF formula F , is it satisfiable?

For instance, what about:

$$(p \vee \bar{u}) \wedge (q \vee r) \wedge (\bar{r} \vee w) \wedge (u \vee x \vee y) \wedge \\ (x \vee \bar{y} \vee z) \wedge (\bar{x} \vee z) \wedge (\bar{y} \vee \bar{z}) \wedge (\bar{x} \vee \bar{z}) \wedge (\bar{p} \vee \bar{u})$$

Proofs for SAT

For satisfiable instances: just specify satisfying assignment

For unsatisfiability: a sequence of clauses (CNF constraints)

- Each clause follows “obviously” from everything we know so far
- Final clause is empty, meaning contradiction (written $\perp$)
- Means original formula must be inconsistent

What Is Obvious? Unit Propagation

Unit Propagation

Clause C **unit propagates** ℓ under partial assignment ρ if ρ falsifies all literals in C except ℓ

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- $p \vee \bar{u}$ propagates $u \mapsto 0$

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- No further unit propagations

Proof checker should know how to unit propagate until saturation

Davis-Putman-Logemann-Loveland (DPLL)

DPLL [DP60, DLL62]: Assign variables and propagate; backtrack when clause violated

“Proof trace”: when backtracking, write negation of guesses made

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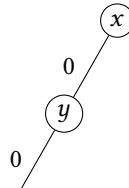


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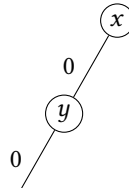


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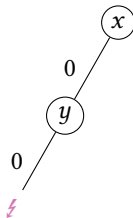
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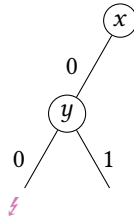
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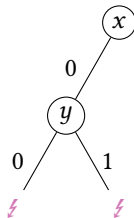
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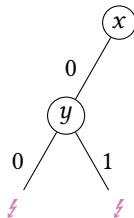
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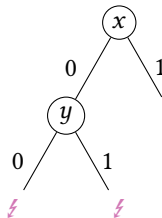
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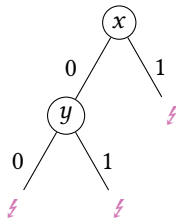
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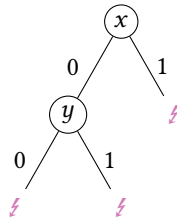
1 $x \vee y$

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4 $\bar{x}$

5 $\perp$



Reverse Unit Propagation (RUP)

To make this into a proof, need backtrack clauses to be easily verifiable

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- assigning C to false
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Fact

Backtrack clauses from DPLL solver generate a proof consisting of RUP clauses

What About Conflict-Driven Clause Learning (CDCL)?

Run CDCL [BS97, MS99, MMZ⁺01] on our favourite CNF formula:

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Given $p = 0$, clause $p \vee \bar{u}$ forces $u = 0$

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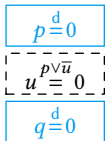
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$$\perp$$

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$$\bar{y} \vee \bar{z} \stackrel{\perp}{=}$$

decision
level 1

decision
level 2

decision
level 3

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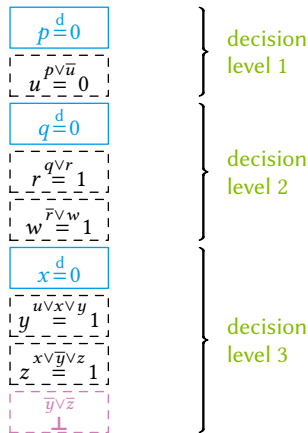
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Conflict Analysis

Time to analyse this conflict and learn from it!

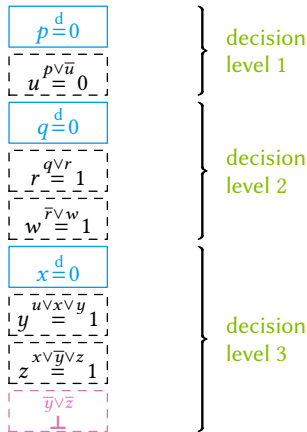
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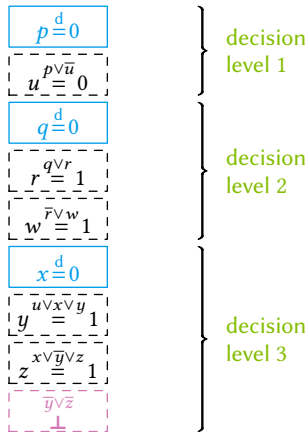


Could backtrack by erasing **conflict level** & flipping last decision

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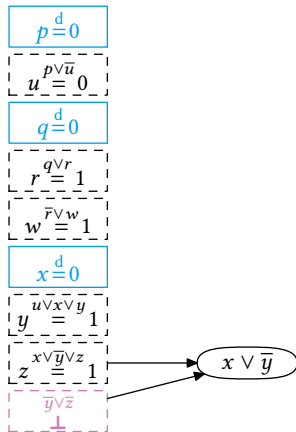
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But want to **learn** from conflict and cut away as much of search space as possible

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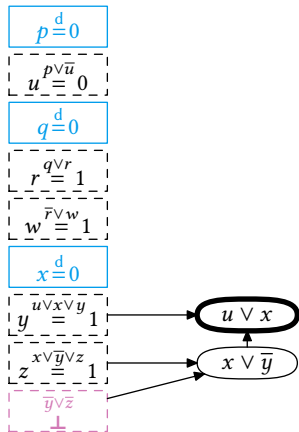
Case analysis over z for last two clauses:

- $x \vee \bar{y} \vee z$ wants $z = 1$
- $\bar{y} \vee \bar{z}$ wants $z = 0$
- **Resolve** clauses by merging them & removing z — must satisfy $x \vee \bar{y}$

Conflict Analysis

Time to analyse this conflict and learn from it!

$$(p \vee \bar{u}) \wedge (q \vee r) \wedge (\bar{r} \vee w) \wedge (u \vee x \vee y) \wedge (x \vee \bar{y} \vee z) \wedge (\bar{x} \vee z) \wedge (\bar{y} \vee \bar{z}) \wedge (\bar{x} \vee \bar{z}) \wedge (\bar{p} \vee \bar{u})$$



Could backtrack by erasing **conflict level** & flipping last decision

But want to **learn** from conflict and cut away as much of search space as possible

Case analysis over z for last two clauses:

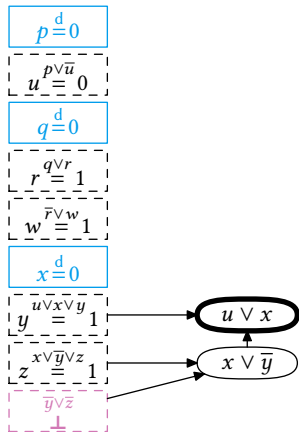
- $x \vee \bar{y} \vee z$ wants $z = 1$
- $\bar{y} \vee \bar{z}$ wants $z = 0$
- **Resolve** clauses by merging them & removing z — must satisfy $x \vee \bar{y}$

Repeat until **UIP clause** with only 1 variable at conflict level after last decision — **learn** and **backjump**

Complete Example of CDCL Execution

Backjump: undo max #decisions while learned clause propagates

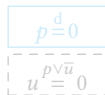
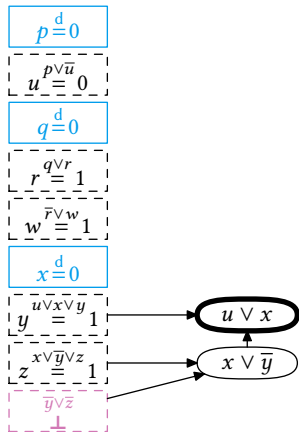
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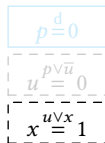
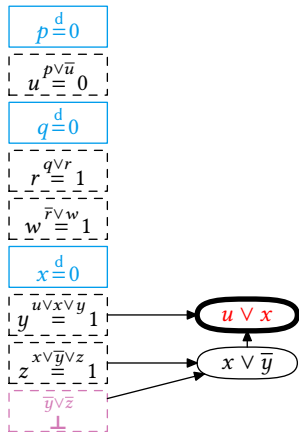


Assertion level 1 (2nd largest level in learned clause) — trim trail to that level

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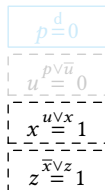
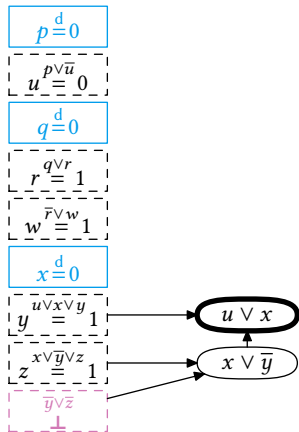
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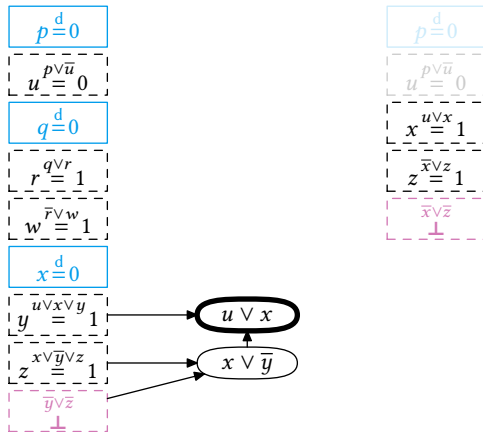
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Then continue as before...

Complete Example of CDCL Execution

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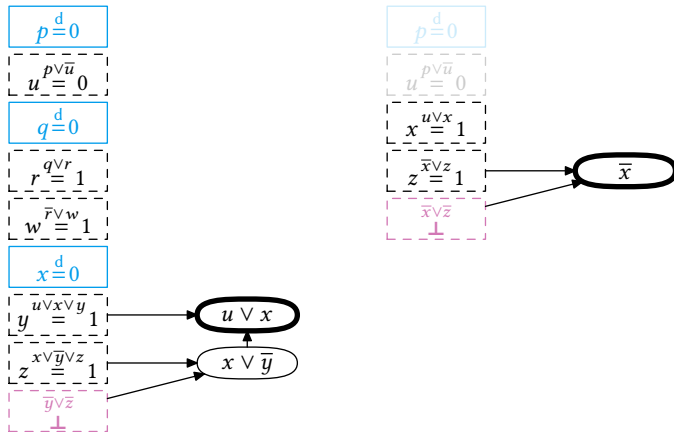
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$$p \stackrel{d}{=} 0$$

$$u \stackrel{p \vee \bar{u}}{=} 0$$

$$q \stackrel{d}{=} 0$$

$$r \stackrel{q \vee r}{=} 1$$

$$w \stackrel{\bar{r} \vee w}{=} 1$$

$$x \stackrel{d}{=} 0$$

$$y \stackrel{u \vee x \vee y}{=} 1$$

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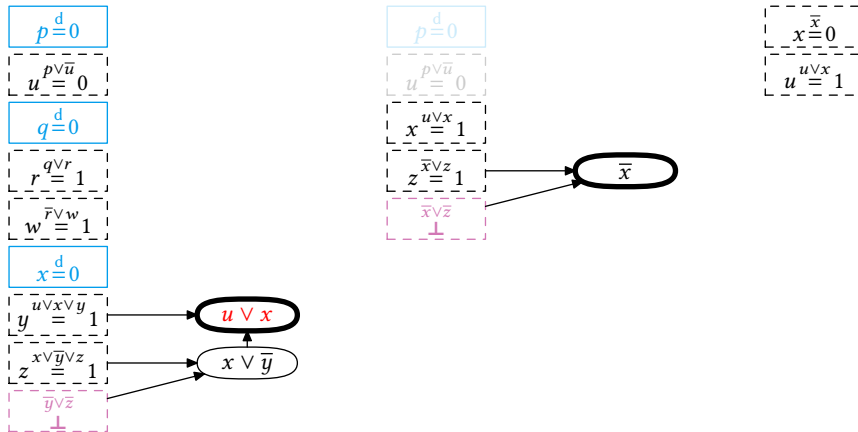
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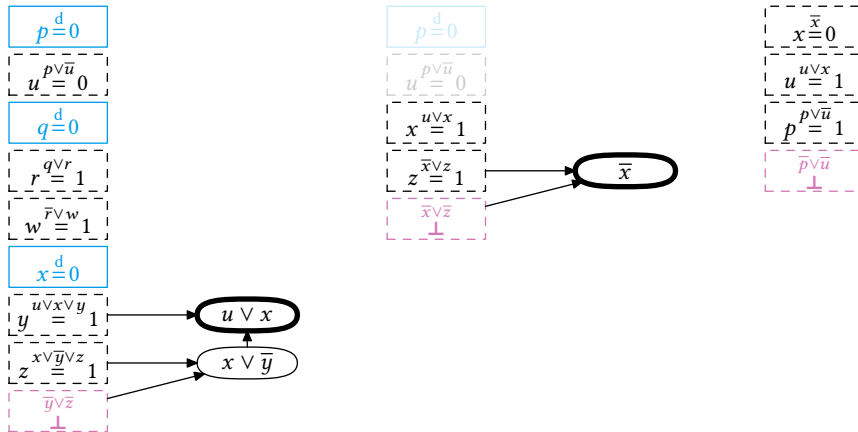
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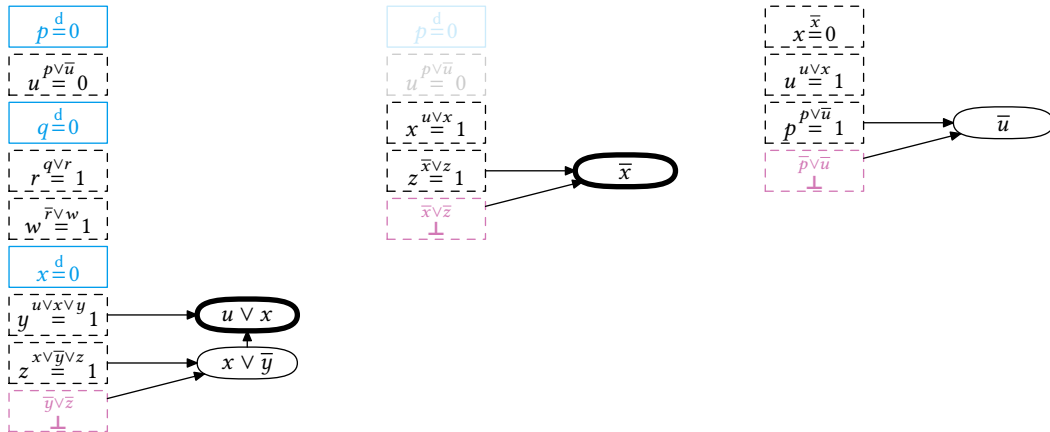
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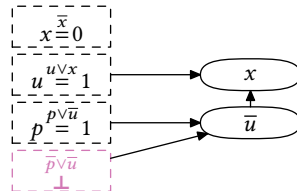
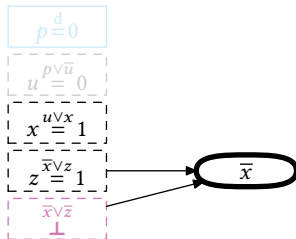
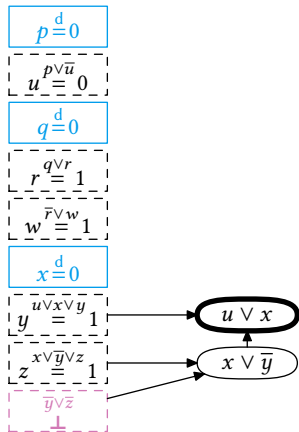
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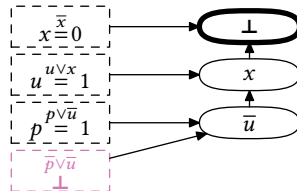
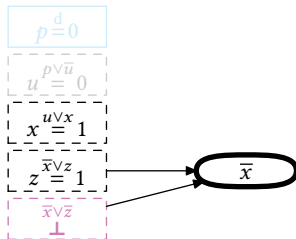
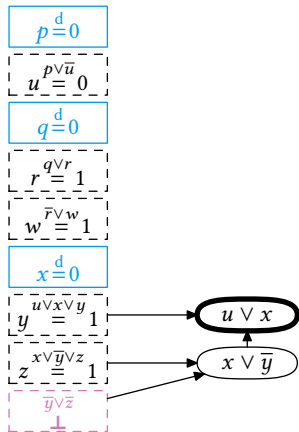
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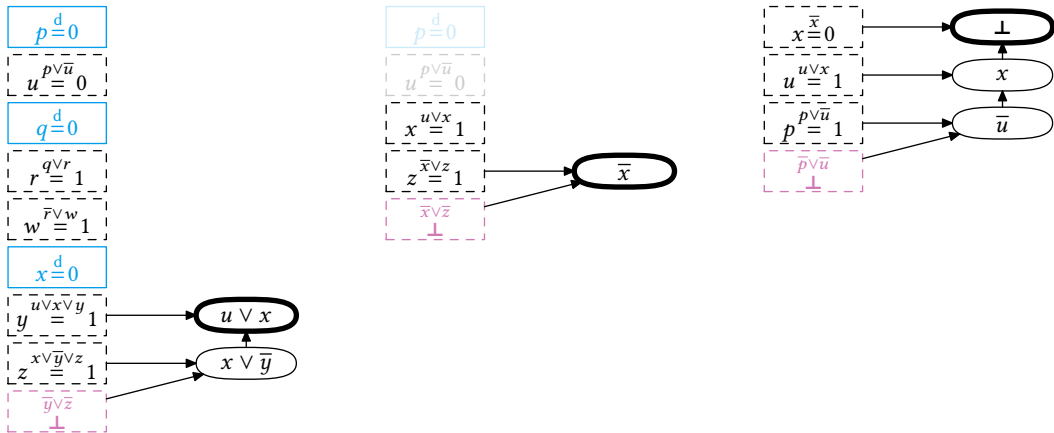
(*) Ignores pre- and inprocessing, but we will get there...

Resolution Proofs from CDCL Executions

Obtain resolution proof...

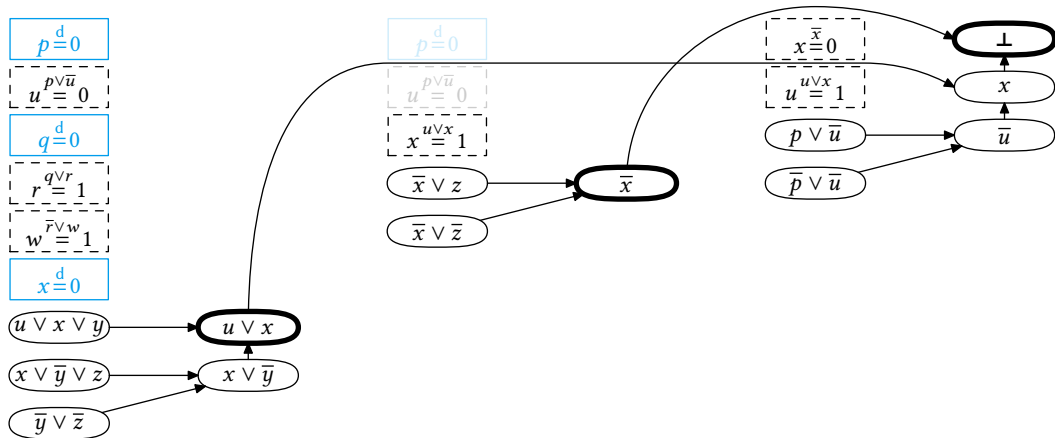
Resolution Proofs from CDCL Executions

Obtain resolution proof from our example CDCL execution...



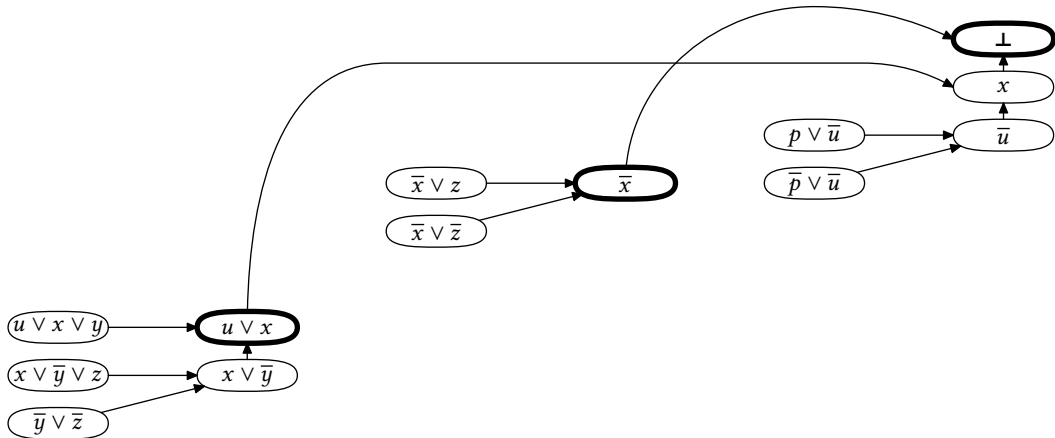
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More Ingredients in Proof Logging for SAT

Fact

RUP proofs can be viewed as shorthand for resolution proofs

See proof complexity and SAT solving survey [BN21] for more on this

But RUP and resolution are not enough for preprocessing, inprocessing, and some other kinds of reasoning

Extension Variables, Part 1

Suppose we want a **reified variable** r encoding

$$r \Leftrightarrow (x \wedge y)$$

Extended resolution [Tse68]

Resolution rule plus **extension rule** introducing clauses

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Fact

Extended resolution (RUP + definition of new variables) is essentially equivalent to the DRAT proof logging system most commonly used for SAT solving [KRH18]

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Practical limitations of current SAT proof logging technology:

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- And more...

Pseudo-Boolean Constraints

0–1 integer linear inequalities or (linear) pseudo-Boolean constraints:

$$\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A$$

- $a_i, A \in \mathbb{Z}$
- **literals** ℓ_i : x_i or $\bar{x}_i$ (where $x_i + \bar{x}_i = 1$)

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Sometimes convenient to use **normalised form** [Bar95] with **all a_i, A positive** (without loss of generality)

Some Types of Pseudo-Boolean Constraints

1 Clauses

$$x_1 \vee \bar{x}_2 \vee x_3 \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad x_1 + \bar{x}_2 + x_3 \geq 1$$

2 Cardinality constraints

$$x_1 + x_2 + x_3 + x_4 \geq 2$$

3 General pseudo-Boolean constraints

$$x_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 3x_3 + 4\bar{x}_4 + 5x_5 \geq 7$$

Pseudo-Boolean Reasoning: Cutting Planes [CCT87]

Input/model axioms

From the input

Pseudo-Boolean Reasoning: Cutting Planes [CCT87]

Input/model axioms

Literal axioms

From the input

$$\overline{\ell_i \geq 0}$$

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Input/model axioms

Literal axioms

Addition

From the input

$$\overline{\ell_i \geq 0}$$

$$\frac{\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A \quad \sum_i b_i \ell_i \geq B}{\sum_i (a_i + b_i) \ell_i \geq A + B}$$

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Multiplication for any $c \in \mathbb{N}^+$

$$\frac{\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A}{\sum_i c a_i \ell_i \geq cA}$$

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Division for any $c \in \mathbb{N}^+$

$$\frac{\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A}{\sum_i \left\lceil \frac{a_i}{c} \right\rceil \ell_i \geq \left\lceil \frac{A}{c} \right\rceil}$$

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Literal axioms

$$\overline{\ell_i \geq 0}$$

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$$\frac{\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A \quad \sum_i b_i \ell_i \geq B}{\sum_i (a_i + b_i) \ell_i \geq A + B}$$

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$$\frac{\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A}{\sum_i \lceil \frac{a_i}{c} \rceil \ell_i \geq \lceil \frac{A}{c} \rceil}$$

Saturation for any $c \in \mathbb{N}^+$
(assumes normalised form)

$$\frac{\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A}{\sum_i \min(a_i, A) \cdot \ell_i \geq A}$$

Cutting Planes Toy Example

$$w + 2x + y \geq 2$$

Cutting Planes Toy Example

$$\text{Multiply by 2} \quad \frac{w + 2x + y \geq 2}{2w + 4x + 2y \geq 4}$$

Cutting Planes Toy Example

$$\text{Multiply by 2} \quad \frac{w + 2x + y \geq 2}{2w + 4x + 2y \geq 4} \quad w + 2x + 4y + 2z \geq 5$$

Cutting Planes Toy Example

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 & w + 2x + y \geq 2 & \\
 \text{Multiply by 2} & \frac{2w + 4x + 2y \geq 4}{} & w + 2x + 4y + 2z \geq 5 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{ + }{3w + 6x + 6y + 2z \geq 9} &
 \end{array}$$

Cutting Planes Toy Example

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 \text{Multiply by 2} & \frac{w + 2x + y \geq 2}{2w + 4x + 2y \geq 4} & \\
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 \end{array}$$

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 & & \frac{\bar{z} \geq 0}{2\bar{z} \geq 0} \text{ Multiply by 2}
 \end{array}$$

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 \text{Multiply by 2} & \frac{w + 2x + y \geq 2}{2w + 4x + 2y \geq 4} & \\
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 \text{Add} & \frac{\bar{z} \geq 0}{2\bar{z} \geq 0} & \text{Multiply by 2} \\
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 \text{Add} & \frac{\bar{z} \geq 0}{2\bar{z} \geq 0} & \text{Multiply by 2} \\
 & \frac{3w + 6x + 6y + 2}{3w + 6x + 6y + 2} \geq 9 &
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 \text{Add} & \frac{3w + 6x + 6y + 2z \geq 9}{3w + 6x + 6y} & \\
 & \geq 7 & \\
 & \frac{\bar{z} \geq 0}{2\bar{z} \geq 0} & \text{Multiply by 2}
 \end{array}$$

Cutting Planes Toy Example

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 & w + 2x + y \geq 2 & \\
 \text{Multiply by 2} & \frac{2w + 4x + 2y \geq 4}{\text{Add}} & \frac{w + 2x + 4y + 2z \geq 5}{\text{Add}} \quad \frac{\bar{z} \geq 0}{\text{Multiply by 2}} \\
 & \frac{3w + 6x + 6y + 2z \geq 9}{\text{Divide by 3}} & \frac{2\bar{z} \geq 0}{\geq 7} \\
 & \frac{w + 2x + 2y}{\geq 2\frac{1}{3}} &
 \end{array}$$

Cutting Planes Toy Example

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 & \frac{w + 2x + 2y \geq 3}{\geq 3} &
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Cutting Planes Toy Example

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 \text{Divide by 3} & \frac{3w + 6x + 6y}{w + 2x + 2y} & \geq 3
 \end{array}$$

Naming constraints by integers and literal axioms by the literal involved (with $\sim$ for negation) as

$$\text{Constraint 1} \doteq 2x + y + w \geq 2$$

$$\text{Constraint 2} \doteq 2x + 4y + 2z + w \geq 5$$

$$\sim z \doteq \bar{z} \geq 0$$

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such a calculation is written in the proof log in reverse Polish notation as*

pol 1 2 * 2 + ~z 2 * + 3 d ;

Cutting Planes Toy Example

Multiply by 2

$$\frac{w + 2x + y \geq 2}{2w + 4x + 2y \geq 4}$$

Add

$$\frac{w + 2x + 4y + 2z \geq 5}{3w + 6x + 6y + 2z \geq 9}$$

Add

$$\frac{\bar{z} \geq 0}{2\bar{z} \geq 0}$$

Multiply by 2

$$\frac{3w + 6x + 6y}{3w + 6x + 6y + 2z} \geq 7$$

Divide by 3

$$\frac{3w + 6x + 6y + 2z}{w + 2x + 2y} \geq 3$$

Naming constraints by integers and literal axioms by the literal involved (with ~ for negation) as

Constraint 1

$\doteq 2x + y + w \geq 2$

Constraint 2

$\doteq 2x + 4y + 2z + w \geq 5$

~z

$\doteq \bar{z} \geq 0$

such a calculation is written in the proof log in reverse Polish notation as*

pol

1

2

*

2

+

~z

2

*

+

3

d

;

(*) Except VERIPB variables have to be at least two characters long, but we abuse syntax slightly here for simplicity

Resolution and Cutting Planes

To simulate resolution step such as

$$\frac{\bar{y} \vee \bar{z} \quad x \vee \bar{y} \vee z}{x \vee \bar{y}}$$

we can perform the cutting planes steps

$$\begin{array}{l} \text{Add} \quad \frac{\bar{y} + \bar{z} \geq 1 \quad x + \bar{y} + z \geq 1}{x + 2\bar{y} \geq 1} \\ \text{Divide by 2} \quad \frac{x + 2\bar{y} \geq 1}{x + \bar{y} \geq 1} \end{array}$$

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Given that the premises are clauses 7 and 5 in our example CNF formula, using references

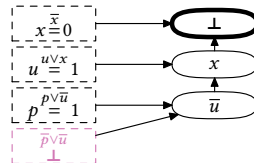
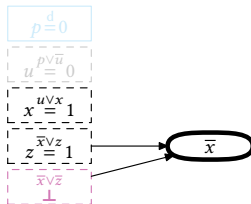
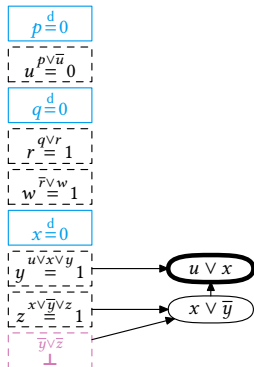
$$\text{Constraint 7} \doteq \bar{y} + \bar{z} \geq 1$$

$$\text{Constraint 5} \doteq x + \bar{y} + z \geq 1$$

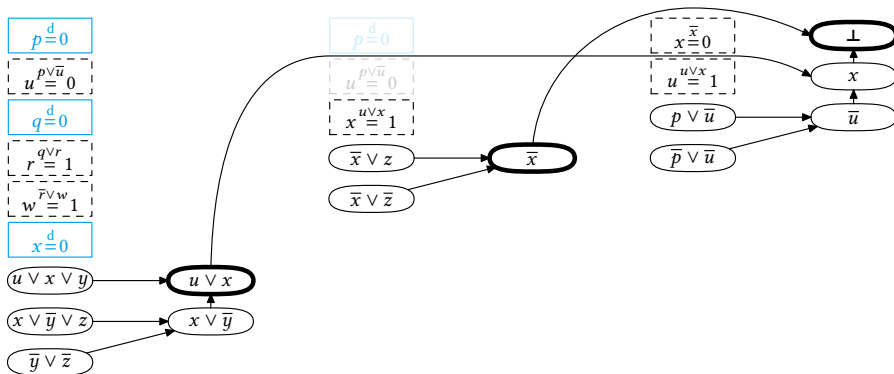
we can write this in the proof log as

pol 7 5 + 2 d ;

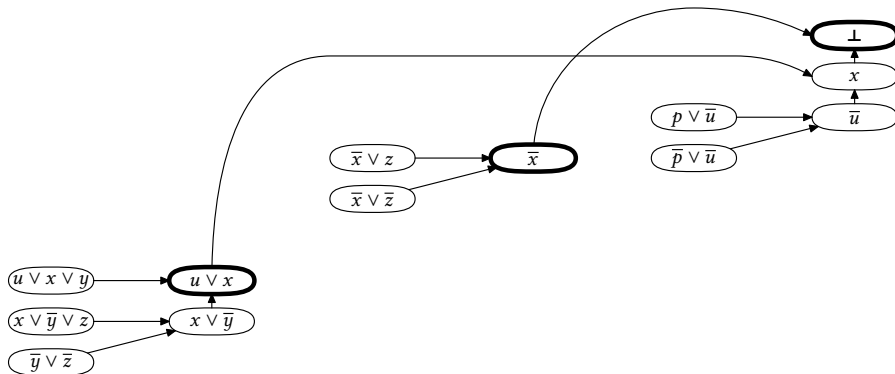
Pseudo-Boolean Proof Logging for Example CDCL Conflict Analyses



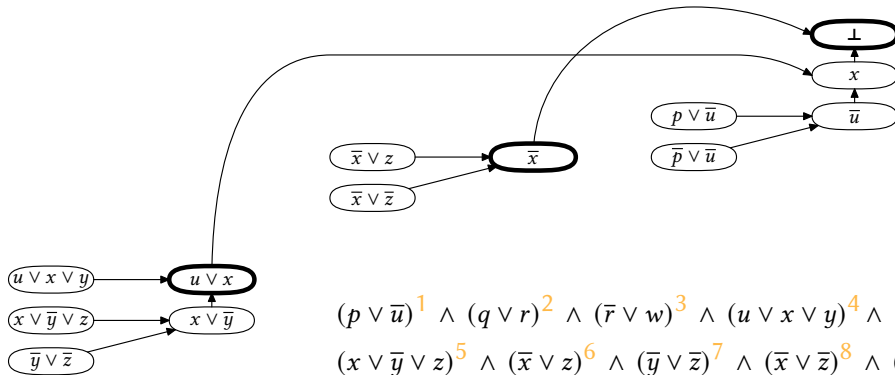
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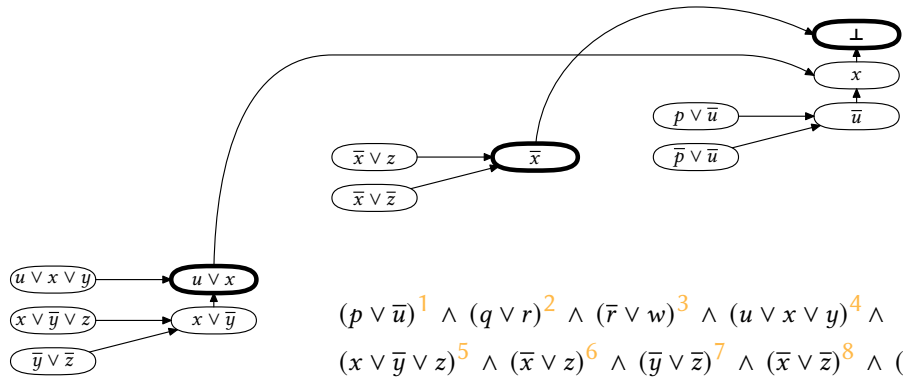
Pseudo-Boolean Proof Logging for Example CDCL Conflict Analyses



Pseudo-Boolean Proof Logging for Example CDCL Conflict Analyses



Pseudo-Boolean Proof Logging for Example CDCL Conflict Analyses



$$(p \vee \bar{u})^1 \wedge (q \vee r)^2 \wedge (\bar{r} \vee w)^3 \wedge (u \vee x \vee y)^4 \wedge (x \vee \bar{y} \vee z)^5 \wedge (\bar{x} \vee z)^6 \wedge (\bar{y} \vee \bar{z})^7 \wedge (\bar{x} \vee \bar{z})^8 \wedge (\bar{p} \vee \bar{u})^9$$

$$\text{pol } 7 \text{ } 5 \text{ } + \text{ } 2 \text{ } d \text{ } 4 \text{ } + \text{ } 2 \text{ } d \text{ } ;$$

$$\text{pol } 8 \text{ } 6 \text{ } + \text{ } 2 \text{ } d \text{ } ;$$

$$\text{pol } 9 \text{ } 1 \text{ } + \text{ } 2 \text{ } d \text{ } 10 \text{ } + \text{ } 2 \text{ } d \text{ } 11 \text{ } + \text{ } 2 \text{ } d \text{ } ;$$

$$\rightsquigarrow \text{Constraint } 10 \doteq u + x \geq 1$$

$$\rightsquigarrow \text{Constraint } 11 \doteq \bar{x} \geq 1$$

$$\rightsquigarrow \text{Constraint } 12 \doteq 0 \geq 1 \quad \textcolor{violet}{\text{⚡}}$$

RUP Revisited

Can define (reverse) unit propagation in a pseudo-Boolean setting [EGMN20]

Constraint C propagates variable x if setting x to “wrong value” would make C unsatisfiable

E.g., if x_5 is false,

$$x_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 3x_3 + 4\bar{x}_4 + 5x_5 \geq 7$$

propagates $\bar{x}_4$ (since other coefficients do not add up to 7)

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Risk for confusion!

- Constraint programming people might call this (reverse) integer bounds consistency
 - Does the same thing if we're working with clauses
 - More interesting for general pseudo-Boolean constraints
- SAT people beware: constraints can propagate multiple times and multiple variables

Propagation, Conflict, and Slack

Slack measures how far assignment ρ is from falsifying $\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A$

Assuming normalised form:

$$\text{slack}(\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A; \rho) = \sum_{i: \rho(\ell_i) \neq 0} a_i - A$$

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Consider $C \doteq x_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 3x_3 + 4\bar{x}_4 + 5x_5 \geq 7$

ρ	$slack(C; \rho)$	comment

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$\{\}$	8	

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$\{\}$	8	
$\{\bar{x}_5\}$	3	propagates $\bar{x}_4$ (coefficient > slack)

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$\{\bar{x}_5, \bar{x}_4, \bar{x}_3, x_2\}$	-2	conflict (slack < 0)

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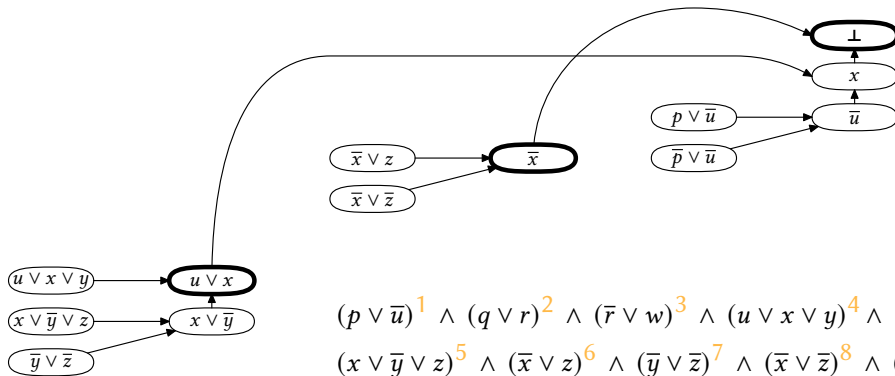
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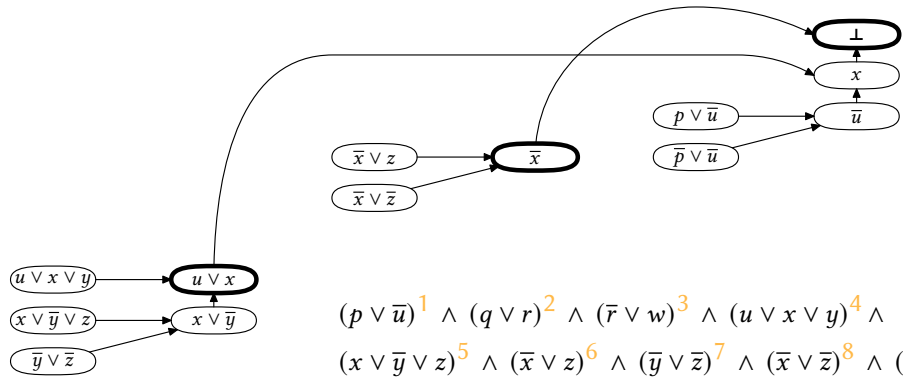
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Note: constraint can be conflicting though not all variables assigned

Pseudo-Boolean Proof Logging for Example CDCL Execution with RUP



Pseudo-Boolean Proof Logging for Example CDCL Execution with RUP



$$(p \vee \bar{u})^1 \wedge (q \vee r)^2 \wedge (\bar{r} \vee w)^3 \wedge (u \vee x \vee y)^4 \wedge (x \vee \bar{y} \vee z)^5 \wedge (\bar{x} \vee z)^6 \wedge (\bar{y} \vee \bar{z})^7 \wedge (\bar{x} \vee \bar{z})^8 \wedge (\bar{p} \vee \bar{u})^9$$

rup 1 u 1 x >= 1 ;
 rup 1 ~x >= 1 ;
 rup >= 1 ;

⇨ Constraint 10 $\doteq u + x \geq 1$
 ⇨ Constraint 11 $\doteq \bar{x} \geq 1$
 ⇨ Constraint 12 $\doteq 0 \geq 1$ ⚡

Extension Variables, Part 2

Suppose we want new, fresh **reified variable** r encoding

$$r \Leftrightarrow (3x + 2y + z + w \geq 3)$$

This time, introduce constraints

$$3\bar{r} + 3x + 2y + z + w \geq 3 \qquad 5r + 3\bar{x} + 2\bar{y} + \bar{z} + \bar{w} \geq 5$$

Again, needs support from the proof system in the form of **strengthening rules**

Proof Logs for “Cutting Planes with Strengthening”

For satisfiable instances: just specify a satisfying assignment.

For unsatisfiability: a sequence of **pseudo-Boolean constraints** in (slight extension of) **OPB format** [RM16]

- Each constraint follows “obviously” from what is known so far
- Either implicitly, by RUP...
- Or by an explicit cutting planes derivation...
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- Final constraint is $0 \geq 1$

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- Final constraint is $0 \geq 1$

(*) Not actually implemented this way — more details in a few slides ...

Optimisation and Enumeration Problems

Optimisation

- Define an objective function $f = \sum_i w_i \ell_i + k$, $w_i, k \in \mathbb{Z}$, to minimise subject to the constraints in the formula
- To maximise, negate objective
- Log solution α with `sol1` rule $\Rightarrow$ objective function value $UB = \sum_i w_i \alpha(\ell_i) + k$
- Add **objective-improving constraint** $f \leq UB - 1$
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- Can also derive and certify (potentially non-tight) lower bound $f \geq LB$

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- Can also derive and certify (potentially non-tight) lower bound $f \geq LB$

Enumeration

- When a solution is found, can log it with solx rule
- Introduces a new constraint saying “not this solution”
- So the proof semantics is “infeasible, except for all the solutions I told you about”

Deleting Constraints

In practice, important to erase constraints to save memory and time during verification

Unsatisfiability proofs: fairly straightforward to deal with from point of view of proof logging

Optimisation and enumeration proofs: significantly more delicate

We will mostly ignore deletions during this tutorial for simplicity and clarity

Pseudo-Boolean Proof Logging — How and Why?

If problem is (special case of) 0-1 integer linear program

- just do proof logging [basically: add print statements to solver code]

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- do proof logging for 0-1 ILP formulation [but solver still works with original input]

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Goldilocks compromise between expressivity and simplicity:

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Pseudo-Boolean Proof Logging — How and Why?

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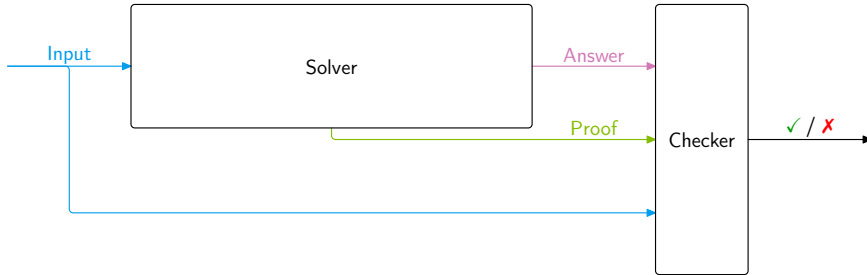
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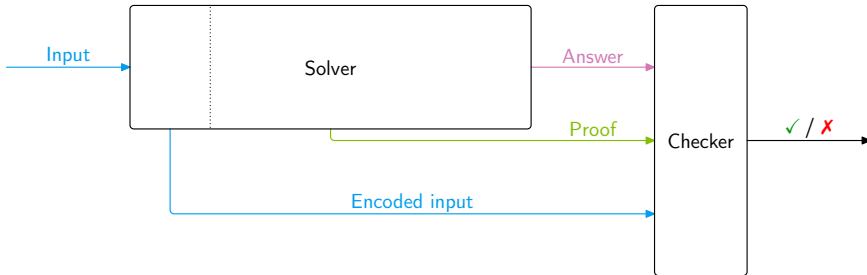
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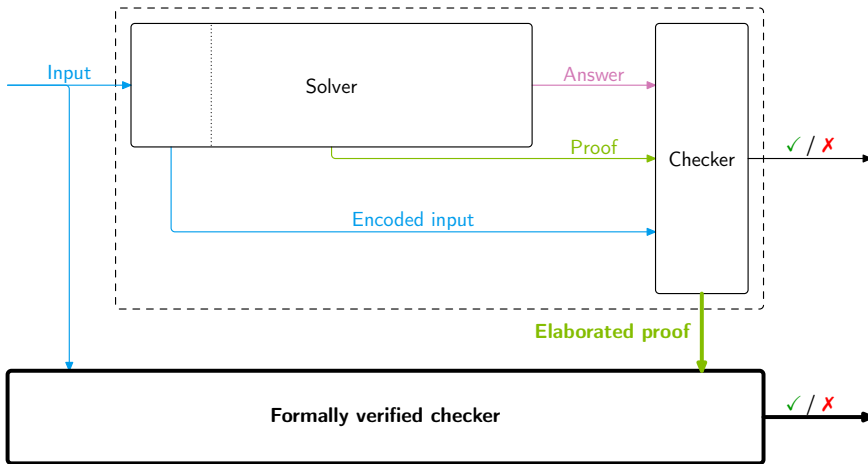
Proof Logging with Formally Verified Checking: Full Workflow



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we introduced pseudo-Boolean constraints

$$3\bar{r} + 3x + 2y + z + w \geq 3 \quad 5r + 3\bar{x} + 2\bar{y} + \bar{z} + \bar{w} \geq 5$$

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Wish to allow **without-loss-of-generality** arguments that can derive non-implied constraints

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C is “**redundant**” with respect to F if F and $F \cup \{C\}$ are **equisatisfiable**

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C is redundant with respect to F if and only if there is a **substitution** ω (mapping variables to truth values or literals), called a **witness**, for which

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VERIPB code:

```
red 3 ~r 3 x 2 y 1 z 1 w >= 3 : r -> 0 ;
red 5 r 3 ~x 2 ~y 1 ~z 1 ~w >= 5 : r -> 1 ;
```

Redundance and Dominance Rules for Optimisation

Redundance-based strengthening, optimisation version

Add constraint C to formula F if exists witness substitution ω s.t.

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- 7 ...
- 8 Can't go on forever, so finally reach α' satisfying both F and C

Strength of Dominance Rule

Dominance-based strengthening (stronger, still simplified)

If $C_1, C_2, \dots, C_{m-1}$ have been derived from F (maybe using dominance), then can derive C_m if exists witness substitution ω s.t.

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- Or pick solution α satisfying F and minimizing f and argue by contradiction

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Now why is *this* sound?

- Same inductive proof as before, but nested
- Or pick solution α satisfying F and minimizing f and argue by contradiction

Further extensions:

- Define dominance rule w.r.t. order independent of objective
- Switch between different orders in same proof
- See [BGMN23, ABB⁺26b] fore more details

Strengthening Rules: Syntax

```
red ⟨Constraint C⟩ : ⟨var1⟩ -> ⟨val1⟩ . . . ⟨varN⟩ -> ⟨valN⟩ : subproof
  subproofs for proof goals
qed;
```

```
dom ⟨Constraint C⟩ : ⟨var1⟩ -> ⟨val1⟩ . . . ⟨varN⟩ -> ⟨valN⟩ : subproof
  subproofs for proof goals
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- Witness ω should be explicitly specified in proof log

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- Witness ω should be explicitly specified in proof log
- Subproofs of proof goals should also be explicit

Strengthening Rules: Syntax

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```
dom ⟨Constraint C⟩ : ⟨var1⟩ -> ⟨val1⟩ . . . ⟨varN⟩ -> ⟨valN⟩ : subproof
  subproofs for proof goals
qed;
```

- Witness ω should be explicitly specified in proof log
- Subproofs of proof goals should also be explicit
- Except can be skipped for proof goals that “obviously” follow, e.g.,
 - by reverse unit propagation (RUP)
 - by simple syntactic implication from other constraint (as in our reification example)
 - if the proof goal is not affected by the witness substitution ω

Successful Applications of Pseudo-Boolean Proof Logging with VERIPB

Surprisingly, pseudo-Boolean reasoning with strengthening rules sufficient to efficiently certify wide range of combinatorial solving techniques and paradigms:

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Surprisingly, pseudo-Boolean reasoning with strengthening rules sufficient to efficiently certify wide range of combinatorial solving techniques and paradigms:

- 1 **Boolean satisfiability (SAT) solving** including advanced techniques such as
 - Gaussian elimination [GN21]
 - symmetry breaking [BGMN23, ABB⁺26b]
- 2 **SAT-based optimization (MaxSAT)** [VDB22, BBN⁺23, BBN⁺24, IOT⁺24, VCB26]
- 3 **Pseudo-Boolean solving and optimization** [GMNO22, KLM⁺25]
- 4 **Graph solving** [GMN20, GMM⁺20, GMM⁺24, DKK⁺26]
- 5 **Dynamic programming and decision diagrams** [DMM⁺24]
- 6 **Presolving in 0–1 integer linear programming** [HOGN24]
- 7 **Constraint programming** [EGMN20, GMN22, MM23, MMN24, MM25]
- 8 **Automated planning** [DHN⁺25]
- 9 **Enumeration of solutions/models** [MNOT26]

VERIPB Resources

VERIPB [tutorials](#), [technical documentation](#), and [more information](#) at
<https://VeriPB.org>



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ABB⁺26a, ABB⁺26b, DKK⁺26, MNOT26, VCB26] and PhD theses [Goc22, Mcl26, Oer26]

Lots of [concrete example files](#) at <https://gitlab.com/MIAOresearch/software/VeriPB>

Summing up the First Lecture



- Combinatorial solving and optimisation is a true success story
- But ensuring correctness is a crucial, and not yet satisfactorily addressed, concern
- Certifying solvers producing machine-verifiable proofs of correctness seems like most promising approach
- Cutting planes reasoning with pseudo-Boolean constraints seems to hit a sweet spot between simplicity and expressivity

Summing up the First Lecture



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- Up next:
 - Break
 - And then more details and practical examples

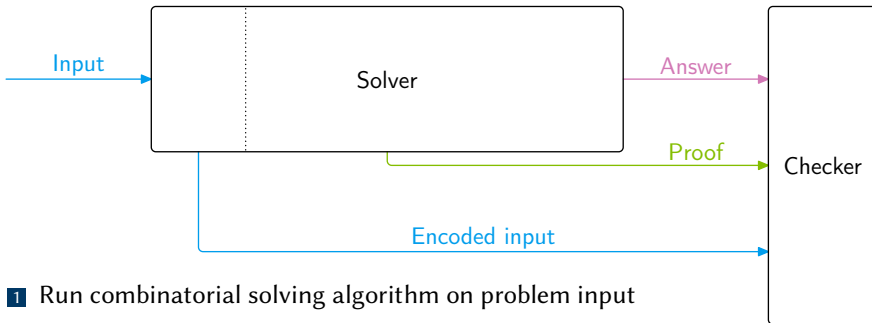
Summing up the First Lecture



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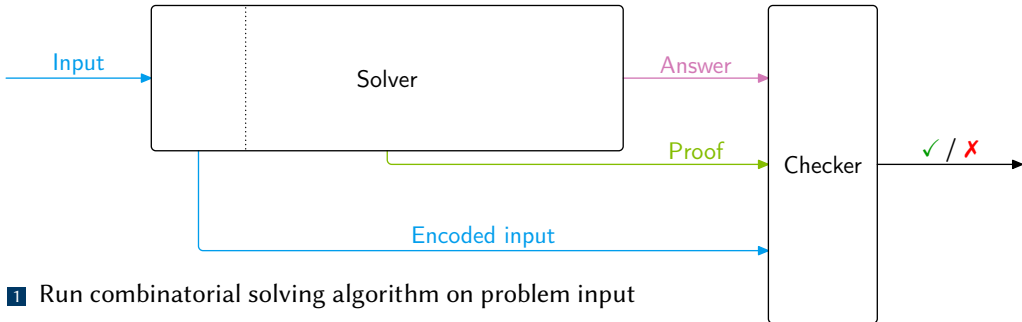
Questions so far?

Recap of Proof Logging Workflow (1/2)



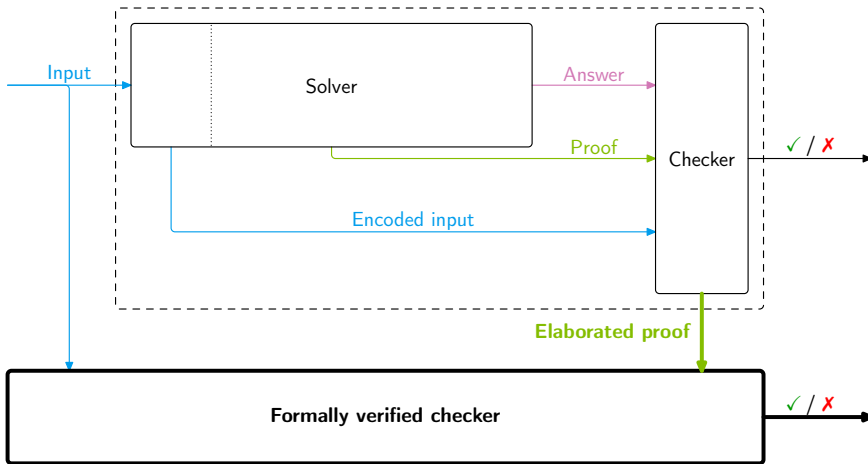
- 1 Run combinatorial solving algorithm on problem input
- 2 Get as output not only answer but also proof
- 3 Feed answer + proof to proof checker together with 0-1 ILP encoding of input

Recap of Proof Logging Workflow (1/2)



- 1 Run combinatorial solving algorithm on problem input
- 2 Get as output not only answer but also proof
- 3 Feed answer + proof to proof checker together with 0-1 ILP encoding of input
- 4 Verify that proof checker says answer is correct

Recap of Proof Logging Workflow (2/2)



Cutting Planes Rules [CCT87]

Input/model axioms

Literal axioms

Addition

Multiplication for any $c \in \mathbb{N}^+$

Division for any $c \in \mathbb{N}^+$

Saturation for any $c \in \mathbb{N}^+$
(assumes normalised form)

From the input

$$\overline{\ell_i \geq 0}$$

$$\frac{\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A \quad \sum_i b_i \ell_i \geq B}{\sum_i (a_i + b_i) \ell_i \geq A + B}$$

$$\frac{\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A}{\sum_i c a_i \ell_i \geq cA}$$

$$\frac{\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A}{\sum_i \lceil \frac{a_i}{c} \rceil \ell_i \geq \lceil \frac{A}{c} \rceil}$$

$$\frac{\sum_i a_i \ell_i \geq A}{\sum_i \min(a_i, A) \cdot \ell_i \geq A}$$

Strengthening Rules in Their (Almost) Full Formal Glory

Witness ω : substitution mapping variables to truth values or literals

Redundance-based strengthening (witness ω show how to “patch assignment”)

Derive constraint C from $\mathcal{C} \cup \mathcal{D}$ if exists witness ω such that

$$\mathcal{C} \cup \mathcal{D} \cup \{\neg C\} \vdash (\mathcal{C} \cup \mathcal{D} \cup \{C\}) \upharpoonright_{\omega} \cup \{f \upharpoonright_{\omega} \leq f\} \cup \mathcal{O}(\vec{z} \upharpoonright_{\omega}, \vec{z})$$

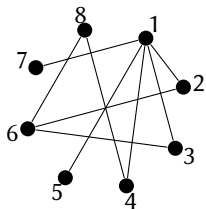
Dominance-based strengthening (witness ω “drives down potential”)

Derive constraint C from $\mathcal{C} \cup \mathcal{D}$ if exists witness ω such that

$$\mathcal{C} \cup \mathcal{D} \cup \{\neg C\} \vdash \mathcal{C}|_{\omega} \cup \{f|_{\omega} \leq f\} \cup \mathcal{O}(\vec{z}|_{\omega}, \vec{z}) \cup \neg \mathcal{O}(\vec{z}, \vec{z}|_{\omega})$$

More Advanced Example of Redundance-Based Strengthening

Is the following graph 2-colourable (bipartite)?



$$b_1 + b_2 \geq 1$$

$$\bar{b}_1 + \bar{b}_2 \geq 1$$

$$b_1 + b_3 \geq 1$$

$$\bar{b}_1 + \bar{b}_3 \geq 1$$

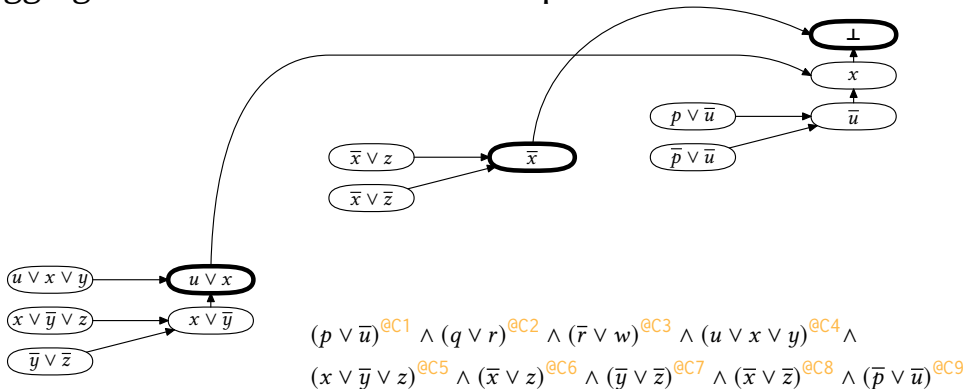
...

Without loss of generality, node 1 is blue (otherwise we can swap the two colours)

64/128



Proof Logging with Labels for CDCL Example



```
@C10 pol @C7 @C5 + 2 d @C4 + 2 d ;
```

$$\rightsquigarrow u + x \geq 1$$

```
@C11 pol @C8 @C6 + 2 d ;
```

$$\rightsquigarrow \bar{x} \geq 1$$

```
@C12 pol @C9 @C1 + 2 d @C10 + 2 d @C11 + 2 d ;
```

$$\rightsquigarrow 0 \geq 1 \quad \text{⚡}$$

Still with $C \doteq x_1 + 2x_2 + 3x_3 + 4x_4 \geq 5$, so that $\neg C \doteq \bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 4\bar{x}_4 \geq 6$
(and recall that $\ell + \bar{\ell} = 1$, so that opposing literals cancel and leave 1)

$$\begin{aligned} C + (r \Leftarrow C) &\doteq 6r + (x_1 + \bar{x}_1) + 2(x_2 + \bar{x}_2) + 3(x_3 + \bar{x}_3) + 4(x_4 + \bar{x}_4) \geq 11 \\ &\doteq 6r \geq 11 - 10 \\ &\doteq \text{deg}(\neg C) \cdot r \geq 1 \end{aligned}$$

The Same Derivation Without Assumptions

Now forget about the assumptions and run exactly the same derivation on the original constraints:

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 & r_1 + x_1 + x_2 \geq 1 & r_1 + x_1 + x_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2r_1 + 2x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \geq 2 & x_2 + x_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2r_1 + 2x_1 + 2x_2 + 2x_3 \geq 3 & \\
 \text{Divide by 2} & \hline
 & r_1 + x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \geq 2 & \bar{r}_2 + \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & & r_1 + \bar{r}_2 \geq 1
 \end{array}$$

The Same Derivation Without Assumptions

Now forget about the assumptions and run exactly the same derivation on the original constraints:

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 \text{Add} & \frac{r_1 + x_1 + x_2 \geq 1}{2r_1 + 2x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \geq 2} & \frac{r_1 + x_1 + x_3 \geq 1}{x_2 + x_3 \geq 1} \\
 \text{Add} & & \\
 \text{Divide by 2} & \frac{2r_1 + 2x_1 + 2x_2 + 2x_3 \geq 3}{r_1 + x_1 + x_2 + x_3 \geq 2} & \bar{r}_2 + \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 \\
 \text{Add} & & \\
 & & r_1 + \bar{r}_2 \geq 1
 \end{array}$$

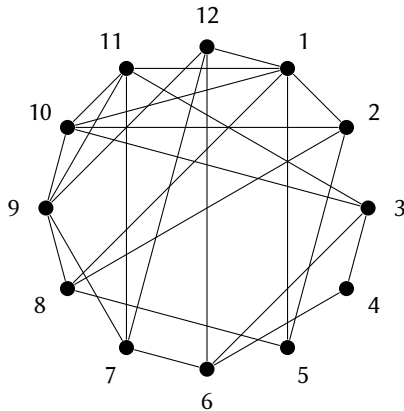
This yields

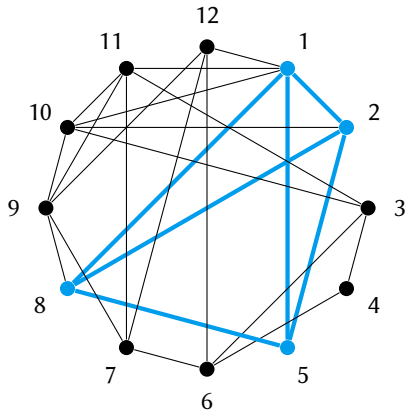
$$r_1 + \bar{r}_2 \geq 1 \quad [\text{VERIPB syntax: } 1 \ r1 \ 1 \ \sim r2 \ >= \ 1 \ ;]$$

or equivalently

$$\bar{r}_1 \wedge r_2 \Rightarrow (0 \geq 1) \quad [\text{VERIPB syntax: } \sim r1 \ r2 ==> >= 1 ;]$$

That is, our assumptions imply contradiction





There are a lot of dedicated solvers for clique problems

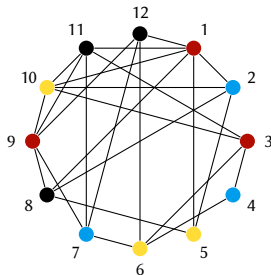
But there are issues:

- “State-of-the-art” solvers have been buggy.
- Often undetected: error rate of around 0.1% [MPP19]

Often used inside other solvers

- An off-by-one result can cause much larger errors

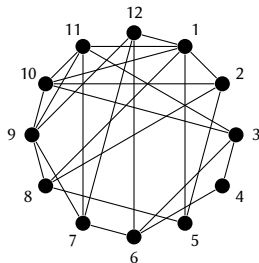
- Pick a vertex v
- Either v is in the clique...
 - Throw away every vertex not adjacent to v
 - If vertices remain, recurse
- ...or v is not in the clique
 - Throw away v (and all incident edges) and pick another vertex



Given a k -colouring of a subgraph, that subgraph cannot have a clique of more than k vertices

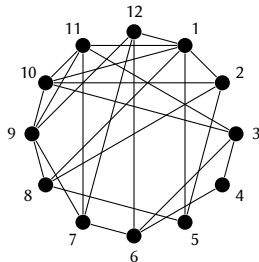
We can use $|C| + \#colours(P)$ as a bound, for any colouring

A Pseudo-Boolean Encoding for Clique (in OPB Format)



```
* #variable= 12 #constraint= 41
min: 1 ~x1 1 ~x2 1 ~x3 1 ~x4 . . . and so on . . . 1 ~x11 1 ~x12 ;
@noedge1_3 -1 x3 -1 x1 >= -1 ;
@noedge2_3 -1 x3 -1 x2 >= -1 ;
@noedge1_4 -1 x4 -1 x1 >= -1 ;
* . . . and a further 38 similar lines for the remaining non-edges
```

A Pseudo-Boolean Encoding for Clique (in OPB Format)



```
* #variable= 12 #constraint= 41
```

```
min: 1 ~x1 1 ~x2 1 ~x3 1 ~x4 . . . and so on . . . 1 ~x11 1 ~x12 ;
```

```
@noedge1_3 -1 x3 -1 x1 >= -1 ;
```

```
@noedge2_3 -1 x3 -1 x2 >= -1 ;
```

```
@noedge1_4 -1 x4 -1 x1 >= -1 ;
```

```
* . . . and a further 38 similar lines for the remaining non-edges
```

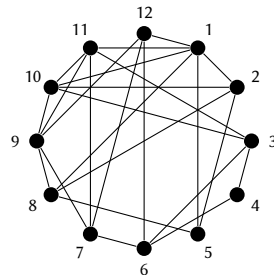
$x_i = 1$ means “vertex i is in the clique”

VERIPB proof minimises number of vertices **not** selected, so 4-clique yields objective value $12 - 4 = 8$

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

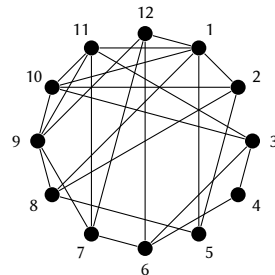
```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;
rup >= 1 ;
output NONE ;
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```



First Attempt at a Proof

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output NONE ;
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```



Start with a header

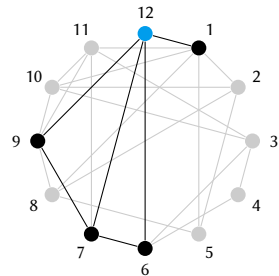
The problem constraints are loaded for us

First Attempt at a Proof

```

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
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rup >= 1 ;
output NONE ;
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;

```

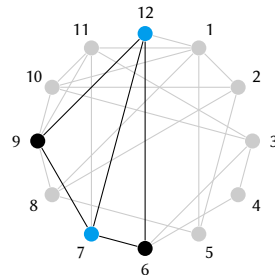


Branch accepting 12
Throw away non-adjacent vertices

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
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rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
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rup >= 1 ;
output NONE ;
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```



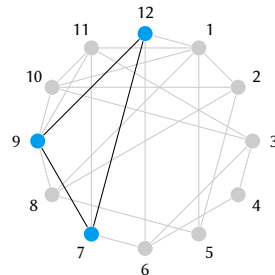
Branch also accepting 7
Throw away non-adjacent vertices

First Attempt at a Proof

```

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;
rup >= 1 ;
output NONE ;
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;

```

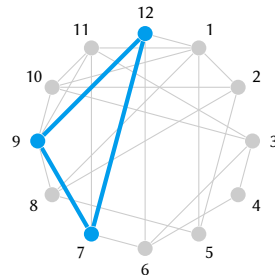


Branch also accepting 9
Throw away non-adjacent vertices

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```



We branched on 12, 7, 9
Found a new incumbent
Now looking for a ≥ 4 vertex clique
“@obj” names the constraint this creates

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
```

```
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
```

```
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
```

```
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
```

```
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
```

```
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
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```
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
```

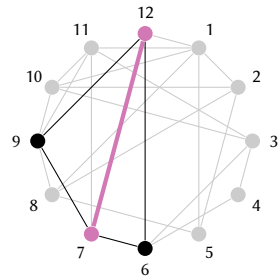
```
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;
```

```
rup >= 1 ;
```

```
output NONE ;
```

```
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
```

```
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

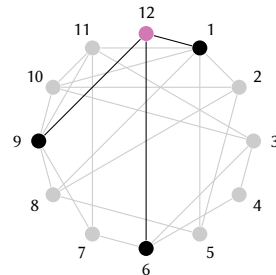


Backtrack from 12, 7
 9 explored already, only 6 feasible
 No ≥ 4 vertex clique possible
 Effectively this deletes the 7–12 edge

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;
rup >= 1 ;
output NONE ;
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

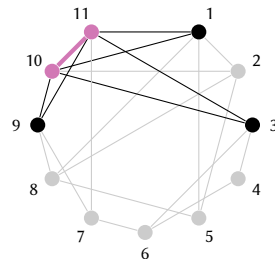


Backtrack from 12
 Only 1, 6 and 9 feasible (1-colourable)
 No ≥ 4 vertex clique possible
 Effectively this deletes vertex 12

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;  
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;  
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;  
rup >= 1 ;  
output NONE ;  
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;  
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

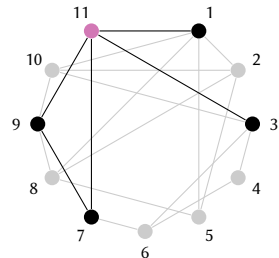


Branch on 11 then 10
Only 1, 3 and 9 feasible (1-colourable)
No ≥ 4 vertex clique possible
Backtrack, deleting the edge

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;
rup >= 1 ;
output NONE ;
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

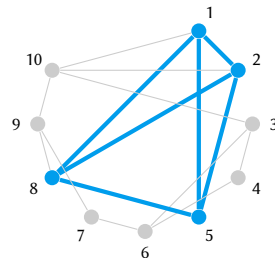


Backtrack from 11
2-colourable, so no ≥ 4 clique
Delete the vertex

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;
rup >= 1 ;
output NONE ;
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```



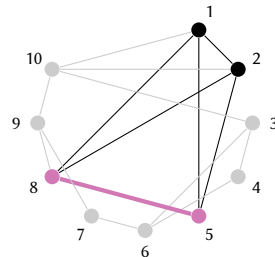
Branch on 8, 5, 1, 2
Find a new incumbent
Now looking for a ≥ 5 vertex clique

First Attempt at a Proof

```

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;
rup >= 1 ;
output NONE ;
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;

```



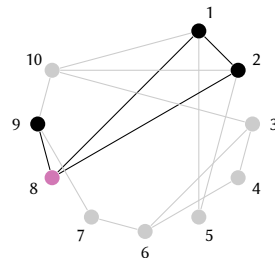
Backtrack from 8, 5
Only 4 vertices; can't have a ≥ 5 clique
Delete the edge

First Attempt at a Proof

```

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;
rup >= 1 ;
output NONE ;
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;

```

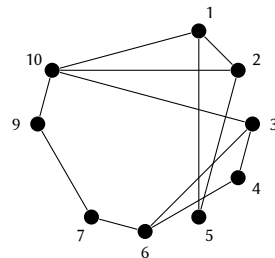


Backtrack from 8
Still not enough vertices
Delete the vertex

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;
rup >= 1 ;
output NONE ;
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```



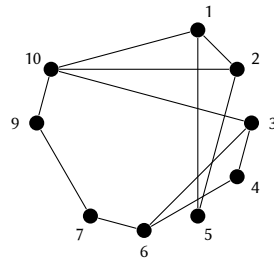
Remaining graph is 3-colourable
Backtrack from root node

First Attempt at a Proof

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

```
@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;
@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;
rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;
rup >= 1 ;
```

```
output NONE ;
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```



Finish with what we've concluded
 We specify a lower and an upper bound
 Remember we're minimising the number of vertices we *don't* select, so a 4-clique has an objective value of $12 - 4 = 8$
 ("output" is for features we're not using)

Verifying This Proof (Or Not...)

```
$ veripb clique.opb clique-attempt-one.pbp
Running VeriPB version 3.0.2
Error: Checking error at clique-attempt-one.pbp:5
```

Caused by:

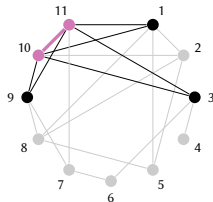
```
The constraint is not implied by reverse unit propagation
(RUP) from core and derived database. Rerun with the option
'--trace-failed' to see the propagations. . . .
```

Verifying This Proof (Or Not...)

```
$ veripb clique.opb clique-attempt-one.pbp
Running VeriPB version 3.0.2
Error: Checking error at clique-attempt-one.pbp:5
```

Caused by:

The constraint is not implied by reverse unit propagation (RUP) from core and derived database. Rerun with the option '--trace-failed' to see the propagations. . . .



Verifying This Proof (Or Not...)

```
$ veripb --trace clique.opb clique-attempt-one.pbp
Running VeriPB version 3.0.2
  Objective: min 1 ~x1 1 ~x2 . . . 1 ~x11 1 ~x12 0
  ConstraintId 1: 1 ~x1 1 ~x3 >= 1
  ConstraintId 2: 1 ~x2 1 ~x3 >= 1
  . . .
  ConstraintId 41: 1 ~x11 1 ~x12 >= 1
line   1: pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0
line   2: @obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
  ConstraintId 42: 1 x1 1 x2 . . . 1 x11 1 x12 >= 4
line   3: rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
  ConstraintId 43: 1 ~x7 1 ~x12 >= 1
line   4: rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;
  ConstraintId 44: 1 ~x12 >= 1
line   5: rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;
Error: Checking error at clique-attempt-one.pbp:5
```


Verifying This Proof (Or Not...)

```
$ veripb --trace-failed clique.opb clique-attempt-one.pbp
```

```
Running VeriPB version 3.0.2
```

```
Propagation check failed! The propagation had the following trail:
```

```
  propagations in format: <assignment> (<reason constraint>)
```

```
    ~x12 (1 ~x12 >= 1)
```

```
    x10 (1 x10 1 x11 >= 2)
```

```
    x11 (1 x10 1 x11 >= 2)
```

```
    ~x4 (1 ~x4 1 ~x10 >= 1)
```

```
    ~x5 (1 ~x5 1 ~x10 >= 1)
```

```
    ~x6 (1 ~x6 1 ~x10 >= 1)
```

```
    ~x7 (1 ~x7 1 ~x10 >= 1)
```

```
    ~x8 (1 ~x8 1 ~x10 >= 1)
```

```
    ~x2 (1 ~x2 1 ~x11 >= 1)
```

```
Error: Checking error at clique-attempt-one.pbp:5
```

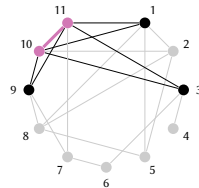
The Problem of Counting

The proof checker isn't smart enough to work out that

- vertices 1, 3 and 9 can all be given the same colour...
- and each colour class contributes at most one vertex to a clique...
- so “find me a clique with more than three vertices” can't be satisfied once we've accepted both 10 and 11

Unit propagation never sees this:

- The bound needs **counting**
- But the encoding only ever talks about **pairs** of vertices



Dealing With Colourings

So the colour bound doesn't follow by reverse unit propagation...

But we can lazily recover at-most-one constraints for each colour class!

Dealing With Colourings

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But we can lazily recover at-most-one constraints for each colour class!

$$\begin{aligned}
 &(\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_6 \geq 1) \\
 + &(\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 1) & = 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_6 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 2 \\
 + &(\bar{x}_6 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 1) & = 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_6 + 2\bar{x}_9 \geq 3 \\
 & & / 2 & = \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_6 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 2 \\
 & & & \text{i.e. } x_1 + x_6 + x_9 \leq 1
 \end{aligned}$$

Dealing With Colourings

So the colour bound doesn't follow by reverse unit propagation...

But we can lazily recover at-most-one constraints for each colour class!

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 &(\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_6 \geq 1) \\
 + &(\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 1) &&= 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_6 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 2 \\
 + &(\bar{x}_6 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 1) &&= 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_6 + 2\bar{x}_9 \geq 3 \\
 &&&/ 2 &&= \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_6 + \bar{x}_9 \geq 2 \\
 &&&&&\text{i.e. } x_1 + x_6 + x_9 \leq 1
 \end{aligned}$$

This generalises to colour classes of any size v

- Each non-edge is used exactly once, $v(v-1)$ additions
- $v-3$ multiplications and $v-2$ divisions

Solvers don't need to "understand" cutting planes to write out this derivation

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (3 Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

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$$\text{Add} \quad \frac{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 \geq 1 \quad \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1}{2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2}$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (3 Variables)

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- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 \geq 1 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 3
 \end{array}$$

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- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 \geq 1 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 3 \\
 \text{Divide by 2} & \hline
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq \frac{3}{2}
 \end{array}$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (3 Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
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$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 \geq 1 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 3 \\
 \text{Divide by 2} & \hline
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq \left\lceil \frac{3}{2} \right\rceil
 \end{array}$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (3 Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
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$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 \geq 1 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 3 \\
 \text{Divide by 2} & \hline
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2
 \end{array}$$

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- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
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$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 \geq 1 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2 & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \hline
 & 2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 3 \\
 \text{Divide by 2} & \hline
 & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2
 \end{array}$$

Assuming constraint $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ has label @C*ij*, get VERIPB code

```
pol @C12 @C13 + @C23 + 2 d ;
```

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (4 and More Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (4 and More Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\text{Multiply by 2} \quad \frac{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2}{2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 4}$$

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- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 \text{Multiply by 2} & \frac{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2}{2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 4} & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 4}{3\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 5} & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 5}{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + 2\bar{x}_4 \geq 6} & \bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + 2\bar{x}_4 \geq 6}{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 3\bar{x}_4 \geq 7} &
 \end{array}$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (4 and More Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
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$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 \text{Multiply by 2} & \frac{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2}{2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 4} & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 4}{3\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 5} & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 5}{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + 2\bar{x}_4 \geq 6} & \bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + 2\bar{x}_4 \geq 6}{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 3\bar{x}_4 \geq 7} & \\
 \text{Divide by 3} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 3\bar{x}_4 \geq 7}{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq \left\lceil \frac{7}{3} \right\rceil} &
 \end{array}$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (4 and More Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
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 \text{Multiply by 2} & \frac{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2}{2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 4} & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
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 \text{Add} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 5}{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + 2\bar{x}_4 \geq 6} & \bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + 2\bar{x}_4 \geq 6}{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 3\bar{x}_4 \geq 7} & \\
 \text{Divide by 3} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 3\bar{x}_4 \geq 7}{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 3} &
 \end{array}$$

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (4 and More Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
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 \text{Add} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 5}{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + 2\bar{x}_4 \geq 6} & \bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + 2\bar{x}_4 \geq 6}{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 3\bar{x}_4 \geq 7} & \\
 \text{Divide by 3} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 3\bar{x}_4 \geq 7}{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 3} &
 \end{array}$$

Assuming constraint $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ has label @C_{ij}, VERIPB code for full derivation is

```
pol @C12 @C13 + @C23 + 2 d 2 * @C14 + @C24 + @C34 + 3 d ;
```

Details on At-Most-One Constraint Recovery (4 and More Variables)

- Derive constraint $x_1 + \dots + x_n \leq 1$ from $\binom{n}{2}$ constraints $x_i + x_j \leq 1$
- I.e., $\bar{x}_1 + \dots + \bar{x}_n \geq n - 1$ from constraints $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ in normalised form
- Need this to prove that **at most one vertex per colour class** can be a member of the clique

$$\begin{array}{rcl}
 \text{Multiply by 2} & \frac{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 \geq 2}{2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 4} & \bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{2\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 \geq 4}{3\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 5} & \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 2\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 5}{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + 2\bar{x}_4 \geq 6} & \bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 1 \\
 \text{Add} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 2\bar{x}_3 + 2\bar{x}_4 \geq 6}{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 3\bar{x}_4 \geq 7} & \\
 \text{Divide by 3} & \frac{3\bar{x}_1 + 3\bar{x}_2 + 3\bar{x}_3 + 3\bar{x}_4 \geq 7}{\bar{x}_1 + \bar{x}_2 + \bar{x}_3 + \bar{x}_4 \geq 3} &
 \end{array}$$

Assuming constraint $\bar{x}_i + \bar{x}_j \geq 1$ has label @C ij , VERIPB code for full derivation is

```
pol @C12 @C13 + @C23 + 2 d 2 * @C14 + @C24 + @C34 + 3 d ;
```

(and this pattern generalizes to any number of variables)

What The Revised Proof with Explicit Counting Looks Like

pseudo-Boolean proof version 3.0

@obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;

rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;

pol @noedge1_6 @noedge1_9 + @noedge6_9 + 2 d @obj + ;

rup 1 ~x12 >= 1 ;

pol @noedge1_3 @noedge1_9 + @noedge3_9 + 2 d @obj + ;

rup 1 ~x11 1 ~x10 >= 1 ;

pol @noedge1_3 @noedge1_7 + @noedge3_7 + 2 d @obj + ;

rup 1 ~x11 >= 1 ;

@obj soli x1 x2 x5 x8 ;

rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;

pol @obj @noedge1_9 + ;

rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;

pol @noedge1_3 @noedge1_7 + @noedge3_7 + 2 d @noedge2_4 @noedge2_9 + @noedge4_9 + 2 d +
@noedge5_6 @noedge5_10 + @noedge6_10 + 2 d + @obj + ;

rup >= 1 ;

output NONE ;

conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;

end pseudo-Boolean proof ;

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rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;

pol @obj @noedge1_9 + ;

rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;

pol @noedge1_3 @noedge1_7 + @noedge3_7 + 2 d @noedge2_4 @noedge2_9 + @noedge4_9 + 2 d +

@noedge5_6 @noedge5_10 + @noedge6_10 + 2 d + @obj + ;

rup >= 1 ;

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Failing RUP steps have become **pol** derivations: add three non-adjacency constraints together, divide by two, then add the result to the solution-improving constraint

The labels come straight out of the OPB file

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rup 1 ~x8 1 ~x5 >= 1 ;
pol @obj @noedge1_9 + ;
rup 1 ~x8 >= 1 ;
```

```
pol @noedge1_3 @noedge1_7 + @noedge3_7 + 2 d @noedge2_4 @noedge2_9 + @noedge4_9 + 2 d +
  @noedge5_6 @noedge5_10 + @noedge6_10 + 2 d + @obj + ;
```

```
rup >= 1 ;
output NONE ;
conclusion BOUNDS 8 8 ;
end pseudo-Boolean proof ;
```

Three colour classes here, so three at-most-one constraints, all added to the solution-improving constraint

Verifying This Proof (For Real, This Time)

```
$ veripb clique.opb clique-new-attempt.pbp
Running VeriPB version 3.0.2
s VERIFIED BOUNDS 8 <= obj <= 8
```

No errors this time — every step is justified

Note that the checker **knows nothing** about

- cliques,
- colourings, or
- bound functions

Verifying This Proof (For Real, This Time)

```
$ veripb --trace clique.opb clique-new-attempt.pbp
Running VeriPB version 3.0.2
Objective: min 1 ~x1 1 ~x2 . . . 1 ~x11 1 ~x12 0
ConstraintId 1: 1 ~x1 1 ~x3 >= 1
. . .
ConstraintId 41: 1 ~x11 1 ~x12 >= 1
line 2: @obj soli x7 x9 x12 ;
ConstraintId 42: 1 x1 1 x2 . . . 1 x11 1 x12 >= 4
line 3: rup 1 ~x12 1 ~x7 >= 1 ;
ConstraintId 43: 1 ~x7 1 ~x12 >= 1
line 4: pol @noedge1_6 @noedge1_9 + @noedge6_9 + 2 d @obj + ;
ConstraintId 44: 1 x2 1 x3 1 x4 1 x5 1 x7 1 x8 1 x10 1 x11 1 x12 >= 3
. . .
line 16: rup >= 1 ;
ConstraintId 55: >= 1
s VERIFIED BOUNDS 8 <= obj <= 8
```


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- Even more for [maximum weight clique](#), where weighted colour class rules get extremely clever (vertices can split their weight between several colours)

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Cutting planes proof system to the rescue!

- Turns out to be strong enough for all of these cases
- Proof length scales linearly with solver reasoning time (asymptotically)

Different Clique Algorithms

Different search orders?

- ✓ Irrelevant for proof logging

Using local search to initialise?

- ✓ Just log the incumbent

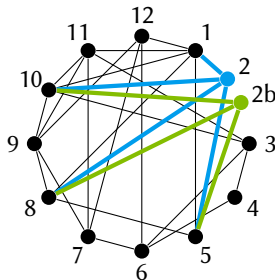
Different bound functions?

- Is cutting planes strong enough to justify every useful bound function ever invented?
- So far, seems like it...

Weighted cliques?

- ✓ Multiply a colour class by its largest weight
- ✓ Also works for vertices “split between colour classes”

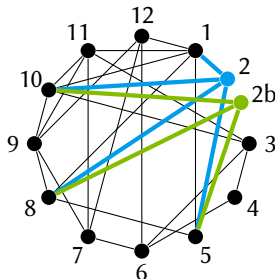
Lazy Global Domination for Maximum Clique [MP16]



Can ignore vertex 2b

- Every neighbour of 2b is also a neighbour of 2
- This is an example of **dominance** reasoning

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Dominance-based strengthening rule can justify this

- Even when detected dynamically during search

Reducing the Trust Base

We are still trusting rather a lot

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- VERIPB can **elaborate** a proof into a simpler **kernel format**
- Uses only rules that the **formally verified** checker **CAKEPB** knows about
- The proof checker CAKEPB (which is written in CAKEML and proved correct in HOL4)
 - reads the **original graph file**
 - does a **formally verified translation to 0–1 ILP**
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- So the answer is formally verified in terms of the original input

End-to-End Verification for Maximum Clique

```
$ glasgow_clique_solver brock200_4.clq
recursions = 56613
clique = 17 (12 19 28 29 38 54 65 71 79 93 117 127 139 161 165 186 192)
runtime = 0.02153s

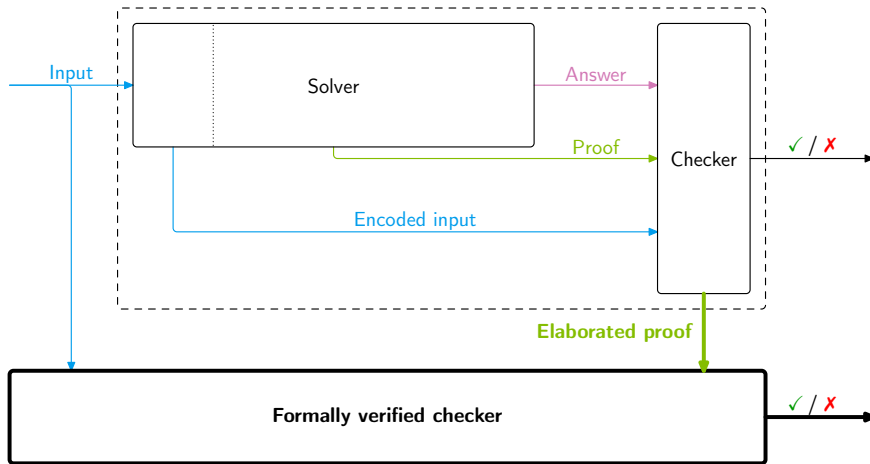
$ glasgow_clique_solver brock200_4.clq --prove brock200_4
runtime = 0.266475s

$ cake_pb_clique brock200_4.clq > brock200_4.verifiedopb

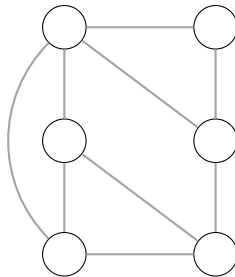
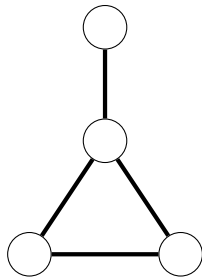
$ veripb --elaborate brock200_4.corepb brock200_4.verifiedopb brock200_4.pbp
s VERIFIED BOUNDS 183 <= obj <= 183

$ cake_pb_clique brock200_4.clq brock200_4.corepb
s VERIFIED MAX CLIQUE SIZE |CLIQUE| = 17
```

Workflow for Solving with End-to-End Certified Results

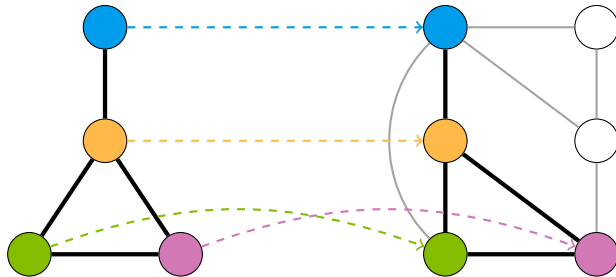


Subgraph Isomorphism



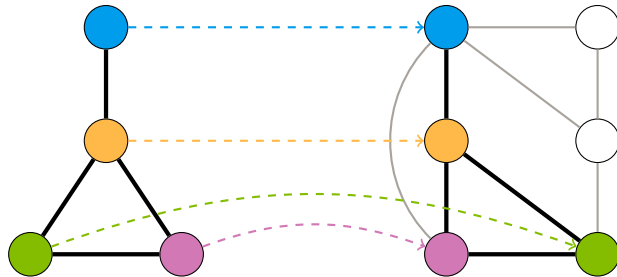
- Find the **pattern** inside the **target**
- Applications in compilers, biochemistry, model checking, pattern recognition, ...
- Often want to find **all** matches

Subgraph Isomorphism



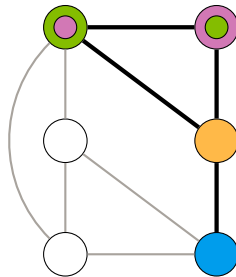
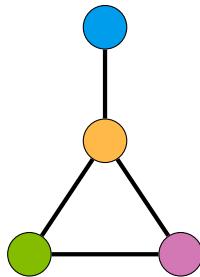
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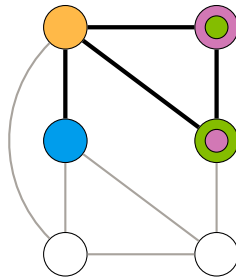
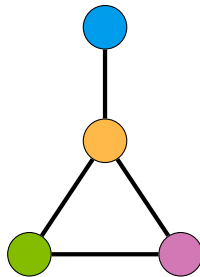
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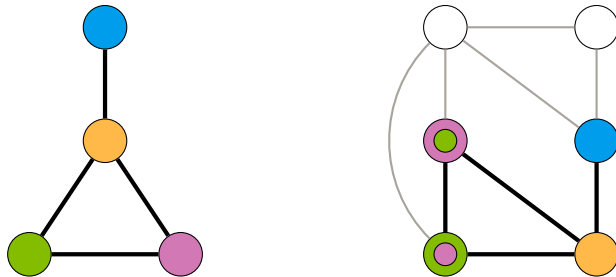
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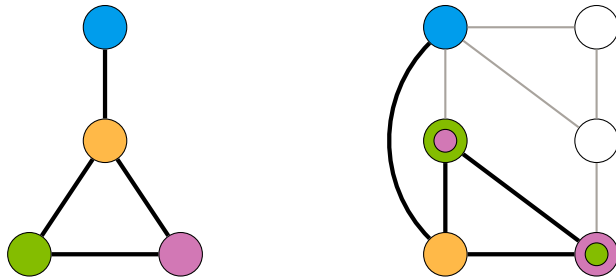
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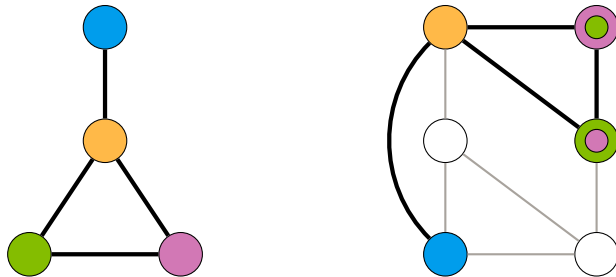
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Subgraph Isomorphism in Pseudo-Boolean Form

Each pattern vertex gets a target vertex:

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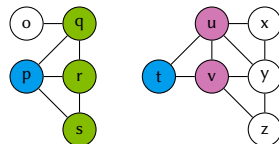
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Adjacency constraints: if p maps to t , then neighbours of p map to neighbours of t :

$$\bar{x}_{p,t} + \sum_{u \in N(t)} x_{q,u} \geq 1 \quad p \in V(P), q \in N(p), t \in V(T)$$

Degree Reasoning in Cutting Planes



Adjacency:

$$\bar{x}_{p,t} + x_{q,u} + x_{q,v} \geq 1$$

$$\bar{x}_{p,t} + x_{r,u} + x_{r,v} \geq 1$$

$$\bar{x}_{p,t} + x_{s,u} + x_{s,v} \geq 1$$

Injectivity:

$$-x_{o,u} + -x_{p,u} + -x_{q,u} + -x_{r,u} + -x_{s,u} \geq -1$$

$$-x_{o,v} + -x_{p,v} + -x_{q,v} + -x_{r,v} + -x_{s,v} \geq -1$$

Literal axioms:

$$x_{o,u} \geq 0$$

$$x_{o,v} \geq 0$$

$$x_{p,u} \geq 0$$

$$x_{p,v} \geq 0$$

Add these together ...

$$3 \cdot \bar{x}_{p,t} \geq 1$$

Possible to certify (almost) all of the other things state-of-the-art subgraph solvers do:

- Conditional injectivity reasoning and filtering
- Distance filtering
- Neighbourhood degree sequences
- Path filtering
- Supplemental graphs

Limitations

Why trust the encoding?

- ✓ For clique and subgraph isomorphism this is now taken care of [GMM⁺24]
- Has to be done again for each new problem, but not too bad

Compiling Table Constraints

Constraints can be specified **extensionally** as list of feasible tuples, called a **table**

Variable assignments must match some row in table

Given table constraint

$$(A, B, C) \in [(1, 2, 3), (1, 3, 4), (2, 2, 5)]$$

define

$$3\bar{t}_1 + a_{=1} + b_{=2} + c_{=3} \geq 3$$

$$\text{i.e., } t_1 \Rightarrow (a_{=1} \wedge b_{=2} \wedge c_{=3})$$

$$3\bar{t}_2 + a_{=1} + b_{=3} + c_{=4} \geq 3$$

$$\text{i.e., } t_2 \Rightarrow (a_{=1} \wedge b_{=3} \wedge c_{=4})$$

$$3\bar{t}_3 + a_{-2} + b_{-2} + c_{-5} \geq 3$$

$$\text{i.e., } t_3 \Rightarrow (a_{=2} \wedge b_{=2} \wedge c_{=5})$$

using newly introduced tuple selector variables

$$t_1 + t_2 + t_3 = 1$$

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i.e., $t_3 \Rightarrow (a_{=2} \wedge b_{=2} \wedge c_{=5})$

using newly introduced tuple selector variables

$$t_1 + t_2 + t_3 = 1$$

Tuple variables **used for proof logging** — need not be known by solver (except for printing proofs)

on of

$$V \in \{1 \quad 4 \quad 5\}$$

$$W \in \{1, 2, 3\} \quad w_1 + w_2 + w_3 \geq 1 \quad [W \text{ takes some value}]$$

$$X \in \{ \quad 2 \quad 3 \quad \}$$

$$Y \in \{1, 3\}$$

$$Z \in \{1, 3\}$$

Justifying All-Different Failures

$V \in \{1 \quad 4 \quad 5\}$				
$W \in \{1 \quad 2 \quad 3 \quad \}$	$w_{=1} +$	$w_{=2} +$	$w_{=3}$	≥ 1 [W takes some value]
$X \in \{ \quad 2 \quad 3 \quad \}$		$x_{=2} +$	$x_{=3}$	≥ 1 [X takes some value]
$Y \in \{1 \quad 3 \quad \}$	$y_{=1}$	$+$	$y_{=3}$	≥ 1 [Y takes some value]
$Z \in \{1 \quad 3 \quad \}$	$z_{=1}$	$+$	$z_{=3}$	≥ 1 [Z takes some value]

Justifying All-Different Failures

$$Z \in \{1, 3\} \quad z_{=1} + z_{=3} \geq 1 \quad [Z \text{ takes some value}]$$

$$-v_{=1} \geq 1 \quad [\text{Sum all constraints so far}]$$

Justifying All-Different Failures

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$W \in \{1 \quad 2 \quad 3 \quad \}$	$w_{=1} +$	$w_{=2} +$	$w_{=3}$	≥ 1	[W takes some value]
$X \in \{ \quad 2 \quad 3 \quad \}$		$x_{=2} +$	$x_{=3}$	≥ 1	[X takes some value]
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$Z \in \{1 \quad 3 \quad \}$	$z_{=1}$	$+$	$z_{=3}$	≥ 1	[Z takes some value]

$$\begin{array}{llll}
\rightarrow & -v_{=1} + -w_{=1} + & -y_{=1} + -z_{=1} \geq -1 & [\text{At most one variable} = 1] \\
\rightarrow & & -w_{=2} + -x_{=2} & \geq -1 \quad [\text{At most one variable} = 2] \\
\rightarrow & & -w_{=3} + -x_{=3} + -y_{=3} + -z_{=3} \geq -1 & [\text{At most one variable} = 3] \\
\\
& -v_{=1} & & \geq 1 \quad [\text{Sum all constraints so far}] \\
& v_{=1} & & \geq 0 \quad [\text{Variable } v_{=1} \text{ non-negative}]
\end{array}$$

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$$-v_{=1} \geq 1 \quad [\text{Sum all constraints so far}]$$

$$v_{=1} \geq 0 \quad [\text{Variable } v_{=1} \text{ non-negative}]$$

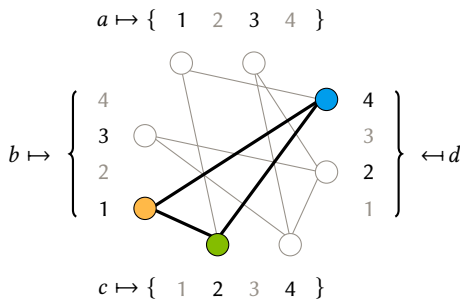
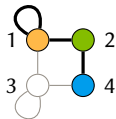
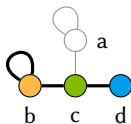
$$0 \leq 1 \quad [\text{Sum above two constraints}]$$

Reformulation

Auto-tabulation is possible

- Heavy use of extension variables

Can re-encode max common subgraph as clique problem without changing PB encoding



How do we know we're giving a proof for the problem the user actually specified?

Need modelling language with formally specified semantics...

The *Glasgow* Constraint Solver

Support for 37 (families of) constraints (and counting), with all inferences certified:

Abs, AllDifferent, AllEqual, Among, AtMostOne, BinPacking, Circuit, Comparison, Count, Cumulative, Diffn, Disjunctive, DivMod, Element, Equals, GCC, In, Increasing, Inverse, Knapsack, Lex, Linear, Logical, MDD, MinDistance, MinMax, Multiply, NValue, Parity, PlusMinus, Power, Regular, SeqPrecedeChain, SmartTable, Sort, Table, ValuePrecede

Also **certifies reformulations** not written in but inferred from input:

- Auto-tabulation: Identify small subproblem, solve it, and replace by table

The *Glasgow* Constraint Solver

Support for 37 (families of) constraints (and counting), with all inferences certified:

Abs, AllDifferent, AllEqual, Among, AtMostOne, BinPacking, Circuit, Comparison, Count, Cumulative, Diffn, Disjunctive, DivMod, Element, Equals, GCC, In, Increasing, Inverse, Knapsack, Lex, Linear, Logical, MDD, MinDistance, MinMax, Multiply, NValue, Parity, PlusMinus, Power, Regular, SeqPrecedeChain, SmartTable, Sort, Table, ValuePrecede

Also **certifies reformulations** not written in but inferred from input:

- Auto-tabulation: Identify small subproblem, solve it, and replace by table
- Capacity strengthening by integrality, conflict cliques across resources, lifted cover cuts: Extract information implied by scheduling problem constraints
- Difference logic: Spot that a pile of two-term inequalities is a precedence network, and hand to temporal propagator

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Details in [EGMN20, GMN22, MM23, MMN24, MM25] (or, better still, talk to Ciaran)

Code at <https://github.com/ciaranm/glasgow-constraint-solver>

Performance of pseudo-Boolean proof logging and checking

- Faster proof logging and checking!
- Trim proofs while checking as in SAT solving [HHW13a] (*upcoming work [ABB⁺26a]*)
- Compress proof files using binary format

- Model counting
- Mixed integer linear programming (*suggested extension of VERIPB in [DEGH23]*)
- Satisfiability modulo theories (SMT) solving (*Lots of work in, e.g., [HS22, BBC⁺23, RSB⁺26, RSS⁺26]*)

- Use proof logs for algorithm analysis or explainability purposes
- Lots of other challenging problems and interesting ideas

Performance of pseudo-Boolean proof logging and checking

- ## Proof logging for other combinatorial problems and techniques

- ## And more...

- We're happy to collaborate, and we're hiring



Summing up

Second half of lecture

- More technical details on VERIPB (mostly for reference)
- Some convenient syntactic sugar (labels and reification)
- Example applications
 - 1 Maximum clique
 - 2 Subgraph isomorphism
 - 3 Constraint programming (*much more about this tomorrow, including hands-on exercises*)

Main message

- Combinatorial solvers are amazing, but **ensuring correctness is crucial**
- **Certifying solvers** producing **machine-verifiable proofs** is the most promising approach
- **Pseudo-Boolean proof logging** has been surprisingly successful in moving the research frontier forward

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